**REQUEST FOR A PROPOSAL**

**Request for a Proposal (RFP) for an Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) Solution**

Request for Proposal No.: **2025-01-ERP Solution**

Release Date: **December 4, 2025**

Date and Time of Closing: **February 16, 2026, 4:00 pm (MST)**

UTILITYnet Contact: Yein Kim

Email: Yein.Kim@utilitynet.net

## Table of Contents


**1.0 Introduction ... 3**

1.1 Company Overview ... 3

1.2 Procurement Overview ... 3

1.3 Current State Overview ... 5

1.4 Future State Vision & Scope ... 6

**2.0 Submission Requirements ... 9**

2.1 Timeline and Key Dates ... 9

2.2 RFP Questions ... 10

2.3 Submission Method ... 10

**3.0 Submission Format and Required Documents ... 11**

3.1 Technical Proposal ... 11

3.2 Pricing ... 12

**4.0 Submission Evaluation Process ... 14**

4.1 Stages of Proposal Evaluation ... 14

4.1.1 Mandatory Requirements ... 14

4.1.2 Technical Proposal ... 14

4.1.3 Pricing ... 15

4.1.4 Presentations and Demonstrations ... 16

4.2 Other Evaluation Considerations ... 17

4.3 Final Scoring ... 18

4.4 Next Steps / Selection Process ... 18

**5.0 Proposal Response Format ... 19**

5.1 Executive Summary ... 19

5.2 Vendor Overview ... 19

5.3 Proposed Vendor Solution ... 20

5.3.1 Proposed Solution Architecture ... 20

5.3.2 Proposed Methodologies ... 21

5.3.3 Proposed Approach ..... 21
5.3.4 Proposed Implementation Roadmap ..... 22
5.4 Vendor Qualifications ..... 23
5.5 Proposed Project Team ..... 23
5.6 Proposed Post-Go-Live Support ..... 23
5.7 Requirements: Vendor Response ..... 24
5.8 Appendices ..... 24
**6.0 Attachments ..... 25**
6.1 Attachment #1: Requirements: Vendor Response ..... 25
6.2 Attachment #2: Pricing Worksheet ..... 25
6.3 Attachment #3: Resume Format ..... 25
**7.0 Appendices ..... 26**
7.1 Appendix A – Define Terms ..... 26
7.2 Appendix B – Business Process Maps ..... 28
7.3 Appendix C – UTILITYnet Proposed Future State High-Level Architecture ..... 30

# 1.0 Introduction

## 1.1 Company Overview

Utility Network and Partners Inc. (UTILITYnet) is a leading utilities retailer based in Alberta, known for its innovative energy solutions and flexible business approach. Through a strong network of over 50 partner organizations, UTILITYnet provides both residential and industrial energy services, offering customers versatile contract options, including pioneering solar energy solutions. As the energy sector evolves, UTILITYnet remains committed to driving progress and future-proofing its operations through advanced technology investments. This Request for Proposal (RFP) invites vendors to partner with UTILITYnet in implementing a next-generation Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) solution that will empower the company to continue its leadership in the retail energy sector, enhance operational efficiency, and support rapid innovation in a dynamic market environment.

UTILITYnet's vision is to lead the transformation of the retail energy sector by leveraging advanced technology and innovative business models. Through this ERP initiative, UTILITYnet aims to empower its team and partners with a flexible, scalable platform that supports rapid adaptation to market changes, enables the launch of new energy products, including renewable and solar options and delivers seamless experiences for both residential and industrial customers. By future-proofing its operations and embracing digital innovation, UTILITYnet will continue to set the standard for agility and excellence in the energy industry, ensuring long-term value for its customers, partners, and stakeholders.

UTILITYnet is composed of a team of professionals with extensive experience in utility operations, energy management, software development, and business process optimization. The organization takes pride in its collaborative spirit, working closely with partners, clients, and stakeholders to co-create practical solutions. Their commitment to reliability, transparency, and sustainability drives the company's vision.

## 1.2 Procurement Overview

**Objective of the RFP**

UTILITYnet is undertaking a transformative initiative to modernize its core business systems and reinforce its position as a leader and innovator in the retail energy sector. This Request for Proposal (RFP) represents a critical step in UTILITYnet's commitment to operational excellence, digital innovation, and future-proofing its business model in a rapidly evolving energy retail landscape.

Through this RFP, UTILITYnet seeks to engage with a qualified vendor capable of delivering a comprehensive, next-generation Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) solution. The selected solution

will replace UTILITYnet's legacy platforms, including Finance and Accounting, Customer Relationship Management (CRM), Data Management, and Business Intelligence systems, with an integrated, scalable, and secure technology ecosystem. This initiative is designed to support UTILITYnet's unique ability to pivot quickly in response to market changes, launch new energy products, and deliver seamless experiences to both residential and industrial customers.

**Key objectives of this procurement include:**

**Enabling Innovation:** Empowering UTILITYnet to remain at the forefront of the energy sector by leveraging advanced technology that supports rapid adaptation, product innovation, and the introduction of new energy offerings, including renewable and solar solutions.

**Operational Agility:** Providing a flexible and modular platform that streamlines business processes, enhances partner integration, and supports UTILITYnet's agile business model and franchise-like network of energy marketers.

**Future-Proofing Technology:** Upgrading UTILITYnet's technology stack to ensure long-term scalability, security, and compliance, while supporting data-driven decision-making and advanced analytics capabilities.

**Customer-Centricity:** Enhancing customer experience through improved service delivery, seamless onboarding, and efficient management of customer interactions across all channels.

**Robust Integration:** Ensuring cohesive integration between finance, CRM, Data Management, and Business Intelligence components to create a unified data architecture that supports strategic planning and operational efficiency.

Vendors are invited to submit proposals that demonstrate a clear understanding of UTILITYnet's strategic vision and operational requirements. Proposals should detail how the proposed solution will address the organization's need for innovation, agility, and future readiness, while aligning with best practices in technology deployment, security, and change management.

The successful vendor will be expected to deliver a solution that not only meets UTILITYnet's immediate business needs but also positions the organization for sustained growth and leadership in the energy sector. The overall implementation is projected to take 2–3 years, with the finance components expected to be completed in 6–9 months through collaborative planning, stakeholder involvement, and focus on measurable results.

By partnering with a forward-thinking technology provider, UTILITYnet aims to set a new standard for excellence in the retail energy industry, driving value for customers, partners, and stakeholders through continuous innovation and operational resilience.

**Description of Needs**

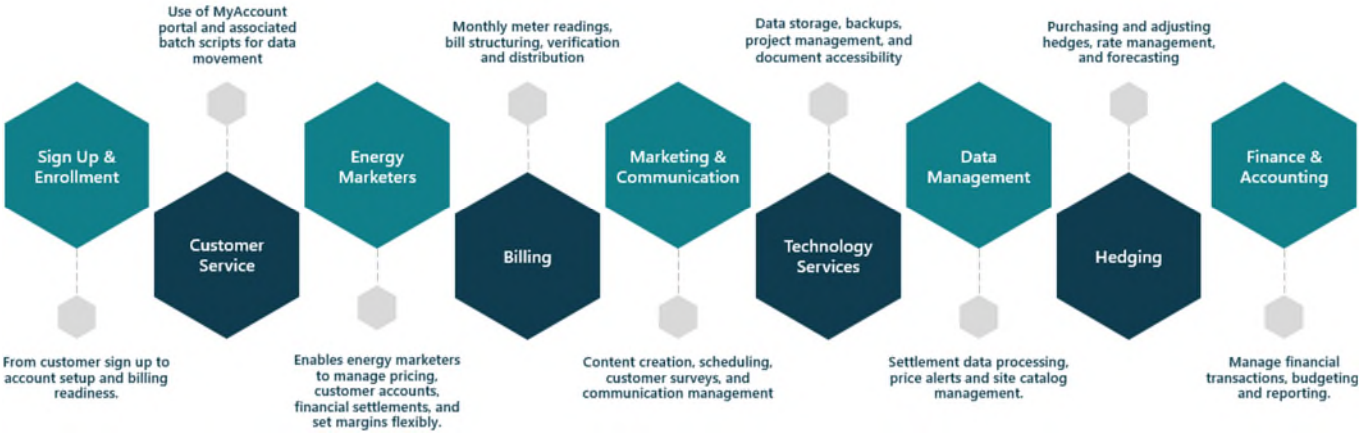
Over the years, UTILITYnet has invested in a robust, custom-built technology ecosystem, including Oracle PL/SQL-based platforms, tailored CRM modules, and dedicated web portals for partner organizations. These systems have been instrumental in supporting UTILITYnet's growth, enabling the company to deliver reliable energy retail services, manage complex billing processes, and foster strong relationships with over 50 partner organizations. The flexibility and scalability of these bespoke solutions have empowered UTILITYnet to innovate in the energy sector, launch new products, and respond quickly to evolving market demands.

As UTILITYnet continues to expand and pursue new opportunities, the organization recognizes the need to build on this strong foundation by adopting a modern, integrated technology platform. The next-generation solution will unify finance, CRM, and Data Management/BI components, leveraging modular, up-to-date technologies and seamless integrations. This evolution will further enhance UTILITYnet's ability to deliver exceptional service, drive operational efficiency, and unlock advanced analytics for strategic decision-making, ensuring the company remains at the forefront of innovation in the retail energy space.

UTILITYnet aims to implement a solution that meets all the requirements outlined in Section 6.1 Attachment #1, leveraging modular, up-to-date technology and then operate it with a blend of internal resources and external vendors through Application Managed Services (AMS) agreements. Technology components must be well integrated to create a cohesive data architecture that enables the development of analytics and BI and supports business decisions based on the resulting data.

## 1.3 Current State Overview

UTILITYnet's operations are structured around several core business capabilities: technology services, billing, customer service, marketing and communication, Energy Marketers, data management, and finance and accounting. Technology services support data storage, backups, project management, and document accessibility. Billing functions include monthly meter readings, bill structuring, verification, and distribution, while customer service is delivered through online portals and call centers. Marketing and communication activities cover content creation, scheduling, customer surveys, and outreach. Energy Marketers manage pricing, customer accounts, financial settlements, and margin setting, supported by dedicated tools and portals. Data management encompasses settlement data processing, price alerts, and site catalogue management. Finance and accounting functions include transaction management, budgeting, reporting, and reconciliation.




Key activities such as enrollment, billing, and settlement rely on platforms including MyAccount, VL Trader, UNET Grid, and Sage50. Manual processes are present in several areas, resulting in inefficiencies and increased risk of errors. Legacy systems limit automation and flexibility, and document management is fragmented across multiple platforms. Customer service tools lack integration for consistent issue tracking and response management, and disconnected systems and manual data entry constrain finance and accounting functions.

UTILITYnet is prioritizing automation, standardization, and system upgrades to address these challenges. Planned enhancements include automating workflows, consolidating document management, implementing advanced customer service tools, and upgrading communication systems. Additional information and supporting details are provided in the appendices of this proposal.

## 1.4 Future State Vision & Scope

UTILITYnet envisions a transformative shift toward a fully digital, integrated, and customer-centric energy platform. The future state is designed to eliminate operational silos and deliver seamless experiences for energy marketers and industrial customers. At its core, this vision emphasizes agility, automation, and sustainability, enabling UTILITYnet to respond rapidly to market dynamics while supporting green initiatives and regulatory compliance. The platform will serve as a foundation for innovation, scalability, and long-term growth, ensuring that UTILITYnet remains a trusted partner in an evolving energy landscape.

This future state will empower customers through intuitive self-service capabilities, real-time data access, and transparent billing processes. Internally, UTILITYnet will benefit from streamlined workflows, automated settlements, and robust analytics, reducing manual intervention and improving decision-making. By leveraging Artificial Intelligence (AI), cloud technologies and API-driven integrations, the organization will achieve operational resilience and security, positioning itself as a leader in digital energy solutions.

To realize this vision, UTILITYnet requires solutions that deliver end-to-end automation, secure data management, and integrated customer engagement tools. Vendors must demonstrate expertise in building scalable, modular platforms that support interoperability across billing, CRM, and marketing systems. Key success factors include high user adoption of digital channels, measurable improvements in operational efficiency, and compliance with industry ethics, security and data governance standards.

The solution should enable UTILITYnet to onboard new Energy Marketers seamlessly, provide advanced analytics for market responsiveness, and offer flexible pricing and hedging capabilities. Additionally, the platform must support omnichannel customer service, proactive communication, and robust financial reconciliation processes. Detailed functional and technical requirements are provided in Attachment 1 – Requirements, which outlines specific capabilities across technology services, billing, customer service, marketing, data management, and finance.

**Scope Definition Based on Key Business Processes**

The future state solution must encompass all major business process areas highlighted in the diagram to ensure end-to-end digital transformation. These areas include:

**Core Finance Capabilities**
This is UTILITYnet's top priority for implementation and should be included in phase one with an approximate implementation timeline of 6-9 months. The solution proposed for this capability should tightly integrate with Sign up and Enrollment, Customer Service (MyAccount), Energy Marketers, Billing and Settlement, and Hedging and Financial Operations.

**Sign Up & Enrollment**
Streamline customer onboarding through automated validation, credit checks, and enrollment workflows. The solution should integrate with existing tools such as My Account and UNET while enabling secure document handling and submission.

**Customer Service (My Account)**
Enhance self-service capabilities and support omnichannel engagement. The platform should manage batch scripts, file transfers, and Call Center integration to deliver a seamless customer experience.

**Energy Marketers**
Provide tools for pricing, margin setting, financial transactions, and analytics. The solution must support real-time reporting and integrate with My Account and Power BI for data-driven decision-making.

**Billing and Settlement**
Cover both Retail/TBF and Industrial billing processes, including bill verification, distribution, hedge allocation, and payment processing. Automation and accuracy are critical to reduce cycle times and

errors.

**Marketing & Communication**
Enable content management, customer feedback collection, and targeted communication campaigns. Integration with platforms like HubSpot and AWS should be supported.

**Technology Services and Data Management**
Deliver robust data storage, backup, and project management capabilities. The solution should also efficiently handle settlement data, price alerts, and Site Catalogue management.

**Hedging and Financial Operations**
Support hedge forecasting and settlement processes with secure, auditable workflows.

## Key Business Processes

| | Sign Up & Enrollment | Customer Service (My Account) | Energy Marketers | Retail/ TBF Billing | Industrial/ Settlement Billing | Marketing & Communication | Technology Services | Data Management (Settlement, Price Alerts, Site Catalog, REA) | | Hedging | Back Office – Finance & Accounting |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Technology | My Account, VL Trader, Site Catalog | Zynxx, FTP Server, VL Trader, Oracle Database, Golden | UNET Grid, MyAccount, Power BI | MyAccount Portal, Batch Scripts | | Blogger, Hootsuite, Constant Contact, AWS | Dropbox, Google Drive, On Premise Servers, JIRA, Confluence | EPSS, AESO Website, UNET Grid, Zynxx, ISIS | | Internal Database (manual entry) | Sage50 Desktop |
| Process | Customer Signs Up on Website | Customer Uses Online Portal | Customer Sign Up and Management | Receive Monthly Meter Read Data | Detailed Billing and CSV Generation | Content Creation and Scheduling | Data Storage and Archiving | Settlement Data Management | Settlement | Purchase and Adjust Hedges | General Ledger Management |
| | Enrollment Request Created | Batch Script Execution | Pricing and Margin Setting | Bill Structuring | Hedge Allocation | Customer Feedback and Surveys | Backup Management | Price Alerts Setup | Data Integration and Processing | Rate Posting and Processing | Accounts Payable/ Receivable |
| | Document Validation and Credit Checks | File Handling for Distributors | Financial Transactions & CFD Settlement | Bill Verification (Golden) | | Client Communication | Project Management and Development | Site Catalog Management | Monthly Settlement Reporting | Hedge Forecasting | Bank Reconciliation |
| | Deposit Requirements (Prudential) (Low Consumption, Typical Consumption, High Consumption) | Call Centre | Pick a Date and Account Adjustments | Bill Distribution | | Phone System Integration | Document Management | Account Management (Internal & External, incl. REA) | Site Recovery and Cost Allocation | Manual Data Management | Financial Statements and Customizable Reports |
| | File Preparation and Submission to RBC | | Analytics and Reporting | Payment Processing | | | | | Detailed Billing and CSV Generation | | Payroll |
| | Application Processing Updates | | | Credit Balance Transfer | | | | | Hedge Allocation | | Budgeting & Forecasting |
| | Batch Script Execution | | | | | | | | | | Data Import/Export |
| | Energy Marketers | | | | | | | | | | |

**Legend** Process | Technology

# 2.0 Submission Requirements

## 2.1 Timeline and Key Dates

The timeline table below presents the key dates and milestones critical to the RFP process. Vendors are encouraged to carefully review each deadline to ensure all requirements are met within the specified timeframes.

| Event | Date |
|---|---|
| RFP Issued Date: | December 04, 2025 |
| Question submission deadline: | December 19, 2025 |
| Issue responses to questions: | January 9, 2026 |
| Proposal Response Submission Deadline: | February 16, 2026 |
| Vendor Shortlist Announcement: | March 2, 2026 |
| Vendor Presentations / Demonstrations: | March 13, 2026 |
| Selection of vendor: | March 27, 2026 |
| Notification date of selected vendor | April 3, 2026 |
| Timeframe for Negotiations | April 10 – May 25, 2026 |
| Estimated Project Start Date: | July 2026 |

**Changes to Timeline**

UTILITYnet may, in its sole discretion, amend any date or time in the RFP, including the Submission Deadline. Any amendment to the Submission Deadline will be communicated to Vendors through the issuance of an addendum. UTILITYnet may choose to waive or extend the Deadline for Vendor Questions and/or the Deadline for Issuing Addenda at any time before the Submission Deadline without prior notice to the Vendors.

**Late or incomplete responses**

Please note that submissions received after the stated due date and time will be disqualified from consideration. Incomplete submissions will be returned to the vendor for clarification and response; vendors must address these requests within three (3) business days to maintain eligibility in the evaluation process.

## 2.2 RFP Questions

Vendors seeking clarification or additional information regarding this RFP must submit their questions via email. All inquiries should be directed to **Yein Kim** at **Yein.Kim@utilitynet.net**. Please ensure that your questions are clearly stated and reference the relevant section of the RFP when applicable.

Questions must be received no later than December 19, 2025. Submissions received after this date may not be considered.

We recommend submitting questions as early as possible to allow adequate time for responses before the proposal submission deadline.

UTILITYnet's response to general questions will be provided by issuing an addendum and posting it on their website.

## 2.3 Submission Method

Responses must be submitted electronically by email to Yein.Kim@utilitynet.net. UTILITYnet does not accept faxed or physical (paper) responses. The subject line should include the RFP # and Vendor Name to assist in collecting responses.

Response Ownership and Limitation of Obligation: UTILITYnet is under no obligation to award work or compensate vendors for any costs incurred in responding to this RFP. All submitted materials become the property of UTILITYnet and may be used for internal purposes. UTILITYnet reserves the right to cancel or withdraw from this process at any time, without liability or commitment of any kind.

# 3.0 Submission Format and Required Documents

Vendors must submit their Proposal in two separate files. Submissions must consist of:

1. **Package 1: TECHNICAL PROPOSAL**
   The technical proposal shall not contain pricing or any financial information. Including pricing information in this package may render the Vendor's Proposal invalid.
2. **Package 2: PRICING**
   This will contain the detailed pricing outlined in Attachment #2.

## 3.1 Technical Proposal

The vendor's response must include the following sections to form the technical proposal package:

1. Executive Summary (Section 5.1)
2. Vendor Overview (Section 5.2)
3. Proposed Vendor Solution (Section 5.3)
   a. Solution Architecture
   b. Methodologies
   c. Approach
   d. Implementation roadmap
4. Vendor Qualifications (Section 5.4)
5. Project Team (Section 5.5)
6. Proposed Post-Go-Live Support (Section 5.6)
7. Requirements: Vendor Response (Section 5.7)
8. Appendices (Section 5.8)

Vendors are limited to a maximum of 35 pages for their primary proposal submission. Vendors are encouraged to use appendices for additional supporting materials, such as technical specifications, case studies, or supplementary documentation. These appendices will not count towards the page limit but should be clearly referenced within the main proposal.

**Mandatory requirements**

For a proposal to be assessed, the vendor must submit evidence of the following mandatory requirements (included but not limited to):

Response documents must be submitted in PDF format and shall not exceed 35 pages of core content, vendors are encouraged to enclose supporting documents as appendices.

Each response must be in English and should adhere to the following format:

a) Single-spaced text, no smaller than 11-point font, except in tables and figures where size 10-point font is acceptable
b) Sequentially numbered pages in each section of the Response
c) Table of contents that includes page numbers, exhibits, tables, attachments, and appendices.

The person submitting the proposal must formally acknowledge that they have the legal authority to sign and submit the response on behalf of their organization.

**Terms and Conditions:** Vendors are required to provide their own copy of proposed contract terms and conditions as part of their submission. These documents will be reviewed and considered by UTILITYnet as part of the evaluation process.

**Amendment of Responses**

Vendors who wish to amend a previously submitted response may do so at any time prior to the Submission Deadline. To initiate an amendment, the Vendor must submit a revised response document clearly marked as "Amended Response" to the designated UTILITYnet RFP contact. The amended submission should include all revised sections and, where applicable, highlight changes from the original response. Amendments must be submitted in accordance with the response formatting requirements and accompanied by a statement from an authorized representative confirming the authority to amend the response on behalf of the Vendor organization. Only the most recent submission received prior to the Submission Deadline will be evaluated.

**Withdrawal of Responses**

At any time throughout the bidding process and prior to execution of an Agreement, a Vendor may withdraw its Response:

- prior to the Submission Deadline, by requesting a withdrawal of the bid email communication to UTILITYnet RFP contact.
- after the Submission Deadline by sending a written notice of withdrawal, signed by an authorized representative of the Vendor, to the UTILITYnet Contact.

## 3.2 Pricing

All vendors are required to submit comprehensive pricing details as part of their proposal in accordance with the instructions provided in this RFP. Pricing submissions must be completed using the designated Attachment 2 - Pricing Worksheet and submitted as a separate PDF file. The information provided will be treated as a critical component in the overall evaluation and selection process. Please ensure that all figures are clear, detailed, and accurately reflect the scope of work as outlined in your submission.

All pricing is to be quoted in Canadian dollars.

Vendors shall describe in detail all of their assumptions in developing their pricing and the impact on pricing if assumptions are not valid.

# 4.0 Submission Evaluation Process

## 4.1 Stages of Proposal Evaluation

UTILITYnet will evaluate proposals in the following four (4) stages:

- Stage 1 - Mandatory Requirements
- Stage 2 - Technical Proposal
- Stage 3 - Pricing
- Stage 4 - Presentations and Demonstrations

The overall scoring will be as follows:

| Evaluation Stage | Points |
|---|---|
| Mandatory Requirements | No points – Pass/Fail only |
| Technical Proposal | 50 points |
| Pricing | 20 points |
| Presentations and Demonstrations | 30 points |
| Total | 100 points |

### 4.1.1 Mandatory Requirements

All Proposals will be reviewed for completeness and compliance. Subject to the terms of this RFP, any Proposals that do not meet the mandatory requirements, either through failure-to-meet or omission, in any material respect, will be disqualified. Proposals deemed to meet the mandatory response requirements will proceed to stage 2 evaluation.

### 4.1.2 Technical Proposal

In this stage of the vendor evaluation process, each Vendor's Proposal will be reviewed by the Evaluation Committee and scored accordingly. The scoring will be done in the manner set forth in Section 3.1 Technical Proposal. The weighting of the scoring of each section will be as follows:

| Section | Max Score |
|---|---|
| Proposed Vendor Solution: Solution Architecture | 10 |
| Proposed Vendor Solution: Methodologies | 5 |
| Proposed Vendor Solution: Approach & Workplan | 5 |

| Section | Max Score |
|---|---|
| Proposed Vendor Solution: Implementation Roadmap | 10 |
| Vendor Qualifications | 10 |
| Proposed Project Team | 15 |
| Proposed Post-Go-Live Support | 5 |
| Requirements – Vendor Response (Attachment 1: Requirements: Vendor Response) | 40 |
| Total | 100 |

UTILITYnet may, at its sole discretion, shortlist vendors after the mandatory requirements and technical proposal stages, disqualifying those with low scores from further consideration.

Vendors must achieve a minimum Technical Proposal score of 60 to advance to the Pricing phase of review. Only proposals that meet or exceed the required minimum will be considered for the next stage of evaluation, ensuring a consistent standard of quality and competitiveness throughout the process.

### 4.1.3 Pricing

Upon completion of the Technical Proposal evaluation, Vendors with a score of 60 or higher (out of 100) will proceed to the Pricing evaluation stage. This stage will consist of reviewing and rating the pricing submitted. Vendors should refer to Attachment #2: Pricing Worksheet. Pricing will be evaluated as follows:

The Total Point Value for Price in the Evaluation Matrix will be determined by applying the following price calculation formula for all proposed prices.

The lowest price of all Proposals/Proposed price x Rating = Total Point Value for Price

Pricing will be weighted at 20 points and scored using a relative pricing formula based on the rates set out in the Pricing Form. Each proponent will receive a percentage of the total possible points allocated to price by dividing that proponent's price by the lowest price submitted. For example, if a proponent proposes $120.00 and that is the lowest proposed price, that proponent receives 100% of the possible points (120/120 = 100%). A proponent who proposes $150.00 receives 80% of the possible points (120/150 = 80%), and a proponent who proposes $240.00 receives 50% of the possible points (120/240 = 50%).

### 4.1.4 Presentations and Demonstrations

In this stage, UTILITYnet will interact with Vendors to better understand their Proposals. This will include presentations and demonstrations from the Vendor highlighting the key advantages of its Proposal will be conducted, and the terms and manner of the presentations are outlined in the section below.

Representatives of the Vendor will conduct interactive demonstrations, collaborating with UTILITYnet's expert users to demonstrate how the Vendor's proposed Deliverables function. This includes demonstrating scripted scenarios or use cases and is expected to last up to three hours across multiple domains and sessions. Once the presentations and interactive demonstrations are complete, points will be awarded to each Vendor to which this stage applies. Afterwards, UTILITYnet will carry out a reference check.

The score breakdown for this stage will be as follows:

| Section | Max Score |
|---|---|
| Vendor Presentation | 30 |
| Scenarios and Demonstrations | 50 |
| References | 20 |
| Total | 100 |

**Vendor Presentation**

Vendors selected based on the scores awarded in the Technical Proposal evaluation step will be invited to present their Proposal at this stage of the evaluation process. The Proposal will be presented at a site of UTILITYnet's choosing in or near Calgary, AB. UTILITYnet will not, in any way, be responsible for any Vendor cost incurred.

The agendas and content for these meetings will be at the discretion of the Vendor, but are expected to include details of the Vendor's proposed deliverables related to UTILITYnet's requirements, how the Vendor will perform the required services as part of those deliverables, and specifics about the implementation team.

To further support vendors in preparing effective demonstrations, UTILITYnet will provide clear guidance and demonstration scripts before the presentation. These resources are intended to help vendors align their presentations with the specific needs and functional requirements outlined in the RFP, ensuring that the demonstrations meaningfully address the evaluation criteria and clearly showcase how each solution will fulfill UTILITYnet's operational objectives.

A Question & Answer session should be scheduled at the end of the Vendor's presentation. The Vendor should use its discretion as to which of its representatives attend the presentation; however, UTILITYnet requires that key implementation project team members be physically present at this meeting.

**Scenarios and Demonstrations**

To demonstrate both the functionality and usability of their proposed Deliverables, the Vendors will be asked to run through specific use cases. These scenarios will cover a variety of typical tasks that UTILITYnet staff perform during normal operations. The scenario run-throughs will:

- Take place at a site of UTILITYnet's choosing in or near Calgary, AB. UTILITYnet will not, in any way, be responsible for any Vendor cost incurred.
- Be executed by key members of the Vendor's implementation team.
- Be attended by UTILITYnet's operational and management employees.
- Cover a broad range of functional and cross-functional tasks.
- Provide UTILITYnet with a hands-on understanding of the Vendor's system.

**References**

Show a proven history of success on projects similar to the Project with organizations such as UTILITYnet. Provide descriptions of up to three previous projects that are alike in size and scope to the Project outlined in this RFP. Preferably include at least one example from the Utilities sector.

Vendors will provide references as outlined in section 3.1 Technical Proposal. Vendors should be ready for verification with those references. UTILITYnet will contact the references to verify details of the implementation of products and services similar to the deliverables in this RFP.

UTILITYnet may then use the information provided by references to reassess the scores in previous stages, and to assess the credibility of the related Proposals.

## 4.2 Other Evaluation Considerations

At any stage of the evaluation process, UTILITYnet may:

- Complete a statement of requirements supplementary to this RFP as a result of matters raised by the evaluation or subsequent reference checks.
- Exclude any Proposal(s) which UTILITYnet determines in its discretion to be incomplete or non-compliant with any mandatory requirements of this RFP.

Response Ownership and Limitation of Obligation: UTILITYnet is under no obligation to award work or compensate vendors for any costs incurred in responding to this RFP. All submitted materials become the property of UTILITYnet and may be used for internal purposes. UTILITYnet reserves the right to cancel or withdraw from this process at any time, without liability or

commitment of any kind.

## 4.3 Final Scoring

Final scoring of the Vendor submissions will be based on the combined scores achieved in stages 2, 3, and 4 as per the scoring criteria described in Section 4.1.

## 4.4 Next Steps / Selection Process

Once a vendor has been chosen, they will be informed. There is a 45-day window to negotiate a successful contract with the selected vendor. If negotiations are unsuccessful, the next qualified vendor may be contacted. UTILITYnet will notify all participants once a candidate has been chosen.

# 5.0 Proposal Response Format

## 5.1 Executive Summary

Vendors must submit an Executive Summary explaining why UTILITYnet should choose them as the preferred vendor. Keep the Executive Summary within a maximum of two pages.

## 5.2 Vendor Overview

Vendors must clearly demonstrate their capacity to deliver the proposed solution by providing comprehensive information on their qualifications. This should include:

1. **Company Background and Financial Stability:** Present an overview of your company, including financial standing and any factors that support long-term viability.
2. **Data Residency**: If your company is not Canadian, describe measures to ensure project data will remain resident in Canada.
3. **Certifications and Partnerships:** Optionally, outline relevant certifications (such as Security – SOC Compliance) and strategic partnerships.
4. **Security Policies:** Provide examples of policies in place related to data protection, privacy, access control, and acceptable use of technology policies. Please specifically address the following:
    - How often does your company review and test its privacy incident and breach management program? Can your company provide evidence that it has controls in place to ensure data collection, access, management, security, and retention are done in accordance with the appropriate laws and regulations?
    - Has your company experienced any information security breaches in the past three years?
    - What data privacy and cybersecurity requirements does your company require of its third parties (fourth parties)? How will it ensure that appropriate information security safeguards are in place?
5. **Other Criteria:** Include proof of insurance coverage, details regarding limitation of liability, and Workers' Compensation Board (WCB) information.
6. **References:** Provide three (3) references for similar-sized projects completed within the last three (3) years. Include a contact name along with a phone number or email address for reference checks. The references may be the same or different from those listed in the projects described under Section 5.3. These references may be contacted as outlined in Section 4.1.4.

By detailing these qualifications, vendors will ensure their expertise, reliability, and preparedness to deliver the proposed solution successfully.

## 5.3 Proposed Vendor Solution

### 5.3.1 Proposed Solution Architecture

The Solution Architecture section is a critical component of your proposal, designed to provide UTILITYnet with a clear understanding of your technical vision and how your solution integrates into the client's broader ecosystem. Please structure this section to address the following key elements:

1. **High-Level Architecture Diagram:** Present a comprehensive diagram that illustrates the main components of your proposed solution and how they interact with each other, as well as with UTILITYnet's existing systems.
2. **Component Descriptions:** Provide concise narratives for each core component, explaining its function and its role in fulfilling UTILITYnet's requirements. Highlight any unique features or innovations that set your architecture apart (including AI and Agents).
3. **Deployment and Security Architecture**: Describe your preferred deployment model (e.g., on-premises, cloud, hybrid), including security mechanisms, authentication, and data protection measures that will safeguard UTILITYnet's assets.
4. **Technology Stack:** List the primary programming languages, frameworks, platforms, and databases that form the foundation of your solution. For each component, vendors must clearly indicate whether it uses proprietary or open technology, provide a rationale for their choice, and demonstrate alignment with UTILITYnet's technology strategy.
5. **Integration and Dependencies:** Identify any required third-party integrations, APIs, or dependencies. Explain how these will be managed and how they contribute to the overall functionality and resilience of the solution.
6. **Alignment with UTILITYnet's Architecture**: Articulate how your solution will fit into UTILITYnet's existing environment. Where possible, reference the provided architecture appendix and highlight areas of seamless integration, required adaptations, or potential challenges.

This structured approach will enable UTILITYnet to assess not only the robustness, scalability, and security of your technical vision but also the compatibility and future-proofing of your proposed solution within the organization's evolving ecosystem.

### 5.3.2 Proposed Methodologies

In this section, vendors must present a high-level overview of the methodologies they intend to apply throughout the implementation. This should encompass project management, change management, risk management, and any other relevant frameworks or best practices that will guide the execution and governance of the project. Vendors are encouraged to summarize their approaches clearly within the main body of the proposal, while leveraging the appendices to provide detailed descriptions or supporting documentation for each methodology, ensuring the core response remains concise and within the prescribed page limit.

### 5.3.3 Proposed Approach

In the Approach and Workplan section, vendors are expected to provide a clear, comprehensive outline of their methodology and the structured steps they will follow to deliver the project to UTILITYnet. This section should demonstrate the vendor's understanding of the project's objectives, requirements, and constraints, and present a practical, logical approach that guides the project from initiation to successful completion. Vendors are also encouraged to use appendices for supporting information, allowing them to supplement their proposals without increasing the core response's page count.

**Key Elements to Address**

1. **Project Methodology:** Articulate the overall methodology that will be applied throughout the project. This should include principles or frameworks (e.g., Agile, Waterfall, Hybrid), along with the rationale for their selection and how they support UTILITYnet's goals and risk appetite.
2. **Risk Management:** Describe the approach to identifying, assessing, and managing project risks, including mitigation strategies and contingency planning to address unforeseen challenges or changes.
3. **Change and Stakeholder Management:** Outline strategies for managing project changes, ensuring stakeholder engagement, and maintaining clear communication throughout the project lifecycle.
4. **Quality Assurance:** Explain the processes and criteria for quality assurance and testing that will ensure the solution meets UTILITYnet's requirements for reliability, security, and performance.
5. **Resource Management:** Detail the resources to be committed to each project phase, including the roles and responsibilities of the vendor's project team, and any expectations for UTILITYnet's participation.
6. **Success Measurement:** Identify key performance indicators (KPIs) or success criteria, and the

methods by which progress and outcomes will be tracked, reviewed, and reported.

7. **Lessons Learned and Continuous Improvement**: Briefly discuss how knowledge transfer, continuous improvement, and lessons learned will be incorporated at each stage to maximize value and ensure sustainable results.

This section intends to provide UTILITYnet with confidence in the vendor's ability to deliver the project efficiently, transparently, and in alignment with the organization's strategic objectives. Vendors should ensure their Approach is tailored to UTILITYnet's specific needs and demonstrates both practical experience and thoughtful planning.

### 5.3.4 Proposed Implementation Roadmap

To ensure a thorough evaluation of each proposal, UTILITYnet requests that vendors provide a comprehensive and transparent implementation roadmap as part of their submission. The roadmap should enable UTILITYnet to assess the overall feasibility, practicality, and credibility of the proposed timeline and milestones, as well as the vendor's capacity to deliver the project as envisioned successfully. UTILITYnet anticipates that the overall implementation will take 2–3 years, with the finance components expected to be completed in 6–9 months through collaborative planning, stakeholder involvement, and a focus on measurable results.

**Key Elements to include in the Implementation Roadmap**

1. **Phase-by-Phase Breakdown**: Vendors should clearly outline all major phases of the project (e.g., discovery, design, configuration, development, testing, deployment, and post-go-live support). For each phase, specify the key activities, intended outcomes, and decision points.
2. **Timeline and Milestones**: Provide an estimated duration for each project phase and highlight all major milestones. Indicate the sequence and dependencies among tasks, and identify critical path activities that could affect the overall timeline.
3. **Decision Gates and Review Cycles**: Describe any decision gates, approval steps, or formal review points embedded in the schedule. Explain how these checkpoints are integrated to monitor progress and facilitate timely adjustments if required.
4. **Assumptions and Dependencies:** Clearly articulate the underlying assumptions that affect the roadmap and call out any external or internal dependencies. This will help UTILITYnet understand the conditions necessary for on-time delivery.
5. **Risk and Contingency Planning**: Outline approaches to identifying and mitigating potential risks to the timeline, including contingency measures for addressing unforeseen challenges or delays.
6. **Flexibility and Adaptability**: Vendors are encouraged to demonstrate how their roadmap

can accommodate changes in scope, regulatory requirements, or other evolving project parameters.

## 5.4 Vendor Qualifications

**Relevant Experience in the Utilities Sector**

Vendors are required to provide three (3) case studies highlighting recent, comparable implementations in the utilities sector. Each reference or case study should clearly demonstrate the vendor's expertise and successful track record in delivering projects similar in scope and complexity. This information will enable UTILITYnet to assess the vendor's familiarity with industry-specific challenges and their capacity to achieve desired outcomes in a utilities environment.

## 5.5 Proposed Project Team

Vendors are expected to present a clear and detailed staffing plan that demonstrates the strength and suitability of the proposed project team. This should include:

1. **Organizational Chart**: Provide an organizational chart showing the structure of the project team, with each member's role and responsibilities clearly indicated.
2. **Resource Profiles:** Submit concise profiles (maximum one page each) for all proposed team members. Each profile should highlight relevant work experience, especially within the utilities sector, as well as education, training, and any security-related certifications.
3. **Availability and Commitment:** Outline the availability and anticipated commitment of each team member for the duration of the project.
4. **Resource Backup Plan:** Describe the contingency plan in case any proposed team member becomes unavailable during key stages of implementation.
5. **Use of Subcontractors:** Indicate if subcontractors will be engaged in any aspect of the project, specifying their roles and responsibilities.

By providing these details, vendors will demonstrate not only the composition of their project team but also the depth of expertise and preparedness they bring to ensure successful delivery.

## 5.6 Proposed Post-Go-Live Support

Vendors should provide a comprehensive summary of their proposed post-go-live support services to demonstrate their organization's capability to deliver reliable and sustained support following the implementation of their solution. Vendors' responses shall include the following:

1. **Support Services:** A description of help desk and technical support offerings, including

support tiers, problem resolution processes, and escalation procedures.

2. **Maintenance:** An overview of approaches for delivering updates, patches, and upgrade strategies.
3. **Monitoring:** Explanation of methods for monitoring system performance and managing issue tracking post-implementation.
4. **Training:** A summary of ongoing training initiatives and user documentation provided to support continued client success.
5. **Account Management**: Identification of dedicated account contacts and the frequency and nature of regular service reviews.

**Optional Services:** Details on managed services offerings or custom enhancements available to UTILITYnet.

Submissions in this area should demonstrate readiness and commitment to support UTILITYnet beyond initial deployment, ensuring reliable service and fostering a strong, collaborative partnership.

## 5.7 Requirements: Vendor Response

Vendors are instructed to complete the requirements Excel spreadsheet provided as Attachment 1: Requirements: Vendor Response Form by responding to each listed requirement directly within the document. For every requirement, please indicate whether your solution meets the specified need and provide relevant details or comments as necessary. Requirements encompass functional, non-functional, regulatory, compliance, and integration aspects, each clearly described and categorized in the sheet.

## 5.8 Appendices

Vendors may elect to include appendices as part of their submission to provide supplementary materials, such as technical diagrams, certifications, case studies, or other relevant documentation that supports their primary response. These appendices are intended to enhance and clarify the information presented, allowing vendors to demonstrate additional qualifications or elaborate on specific aspects without impacting the main body of their proposal.

Please note that appendices are for reference purposes only and will not be counted toward the total page limit of the primary response. Vendors are encouraged to clearly label and reference any appended material within their primary response for ease of review.

# 6.0 Attachments

## 6.1 Attachment #1: Requirements: Vendor Response

Provided as a separate file.

## 6.2 Attachment #2: Pricing Worksheet

Provided as a separate file.

## 6.3 Attachment #3: Resume Format

**Instructions:** Vendors are required to complete all fields below for each proposed resource as part of their RFP submission. Please provide clear and accurate information, limited to 1 page.
Attach additional pages for each resource.

| Resource Name: |
|---|
| |
| **Resource Location (City, Province):** |
| |
| **Utility Industry Experience (Include number of years, relevant roles held, projects)** |
| |
| **Education (Include institution, year completed, program)** |
| |
| **Training/ Certifications (include course name, provider, completion date)** |
| |

# 7.0 Appendices

## 7.1 Appendix A – Define Terms

**Agreement**: means the written contract to be entered into between the Negotiations Vendor and Utility Network & Partners Inc. (UTILITYnet) for the provisions of the deliverables. Negotiations will begin once a vendor has been shortlisted. Vendors will be asked to provide their standard terms and conditions for review.

**Addendum:** an official written amendment or clarification issued by UTILITYnet after the RFP release date. It supplements the original RFP content and becomes part of the official RFP documentation.

**Date and Time of Closing**: the final deadline by which all proposal submissions must be received by UTILITYnet. Submissions received after this specified date and time will not be considered. The closing date and time are stated on the RFP cover page and are based on the local time zone of the issuing office.

**Estimated Project Start Date:** anticipated date on which project activities are expected to commence, subject to final contract execution and any required approvals.

**Negotiations:** the process of discussion between UTILITYnet and the selected vendor to clarify terms, refine proposals, and reach a mutual agreement prior to finalizing a contract.

**Release Date:** the date by which the Request for Proposal (RFP) is officially issued and made available to potential respondents.

**Responses to questions:** Written answers provided by UTILITYnet to inquiries submitted by potential bidders. These responses clarify the RFP content and form part of the official documentation.

**Question submission deadline:** the final date and time by which potential vendors must submit any questions or requests for clarification regarding the RFP to the UTILITYnet contact. Questions received after this deadline may not be answered.

**Selected vendor:** the vendor whose proposal response has been evaluated and determined to meet the requirements of the RFP best, and who is chosen to enter into contract negotiations or awarded the contract.

**UTILITYnet Contact:** means the designated individual who is UTILITYnet's contact person for all RFP matters as identified on the RFP cover page.

**Vendor Shortlist**: The group of vendors selected for further consideration based on their initial proposal's alignment with the RFP requirements. These vendors will be invited to present and demonstrate their proposed solutions.

## 7.2 Appendix B – Business Process Maps

The core capabilities of UTILITYnet are comprehensively depicted in the business process maps, which are provided as a separate file for reference. These maps offer a detailed visual overview of the fundamental processes and operational workflows that support UTILITYnet's business model. Further description of UTILITYnet's core capabilities is provided below, outlining the key activities and supporting technologies that enable the company to enroll new customers, manage billing, mitigate energy price risks, and deliver customer service through its network of Energy Marketers and internal teams.

**UTILITYnet Core Capabilities**

As a utilities retailer, UTILITYnet's business is based on finding and enrolling new utility customers. To achieve this, the company has a network of over 50 partner organizations that sell utility contracts to residential and industrial customers. These partners are termed 'Energy Marketers'. On a monthly basis, customers need to be billed based on their agreed rate per their contract. Data files are shared with UTILITYnet from the electricity distributor of record (also referred to as the 'wire company' or 'wire') through an industry-standard technology, VL Trader. These details are shared via applications per energy customer. UTILITYnet processes the files, calculating the value owed based on the electricity consumed, and issues the customer a bill for the appropriate amount. UTILITYnet manages its risk exposure to energy price fluctuations by purchasing hedges that lock in its energy purchases at a predetermined rate. These capabilities are supported by several internal services (e.g., Finance and Technology), and new customers are targeted through marketing and communication channels. Existing customers, as well as onboarding and offboarding of new/departing customers, are handled by the business' Customer Service team.

Each of these capabilities is supported by a custom-built piece of software, except for Finance, which utilizes Sage 50 as its core tool. The following technologies are used to develop the existing software stack.

| Development Technology | Systems in Use |
|---|---|
| Google Web Toolkit (GWT) | A Java to JavaScript translation and optimization framework used for Web based JavaScript Applications |
| Google Charts | Graphing framework for web applications |
| Python | Solar club graph generation |
| PLPDF | PL/SQL Reporting and Document Generation |
| Oracle PL/SQL | Billing database, Reporting system |

| Development Technology | Systems in Use |
|---|---|
| Java Jakarta EE 8 | Used in the Application Servers |
| Java | Programming language used for Applications |
| VB script | Scripting and sending automated Emails |
| JavaScript | Web interactivity |
| HTML | Frontend page structure |
| CSS | UI styling |
| XSLT | Styling language for XML |
| AWS | Cloud storage - S3 buckets, Cloud Front , SES, SNS ,SQS... |
| Oracle cloud | Database backups |
| Google drive | File storage and sharing |
| Google Docs | Document collaboration |
| Gmail | Official email communication |
| Gchat | Team communication and collaboration |
| Outlook | Email communication and scheduling |

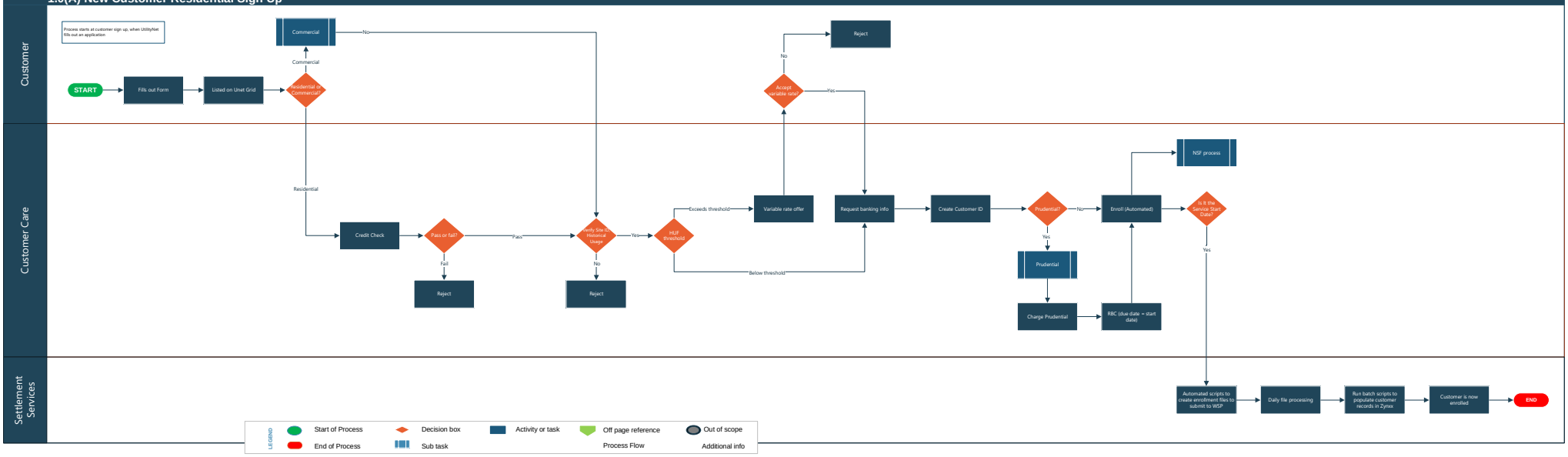
# Journey Mapping

## Process Flow Diagrams


| | |
|---|---|
| 1.0(A) | New Customer Residential Sign-Up |
| 1.0(B) | Existing Customer Residential Sign-Up |
| 1.1 | Commercial Sign Up |
| 1.2 | Request for Update |
| 2.0 | Customer Service |
| 3.0 | Energy Marketers |
| 3.1 | Set Rates |
| 3.2 | EM Reconciliation |
| 4.0 | Retail/TBF Billing |
| 4.1 | Settlement |
| 5.0 | Industrial Settlement Set Up |
| 5.1 | Industrial Settlement Billing |
| 5.2 | Retailer Invoicing |
| 5.3 | Daily File Processing |
| 6.0 | Marketing |
| 7.0 | Executive Team |
| 8.0 | F&A Pre AP |
| 8.1 | F&A AP |
| 8.2 | F&A AR |
| 8.3 | F&A Year End Process |
| 8.4 | R&A NSF |
| 8.5 | F&A Payroll |
| 8.6 | F&A Banking Reconciliation |

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

## 1.0(A) New Customer Residential Sign Up

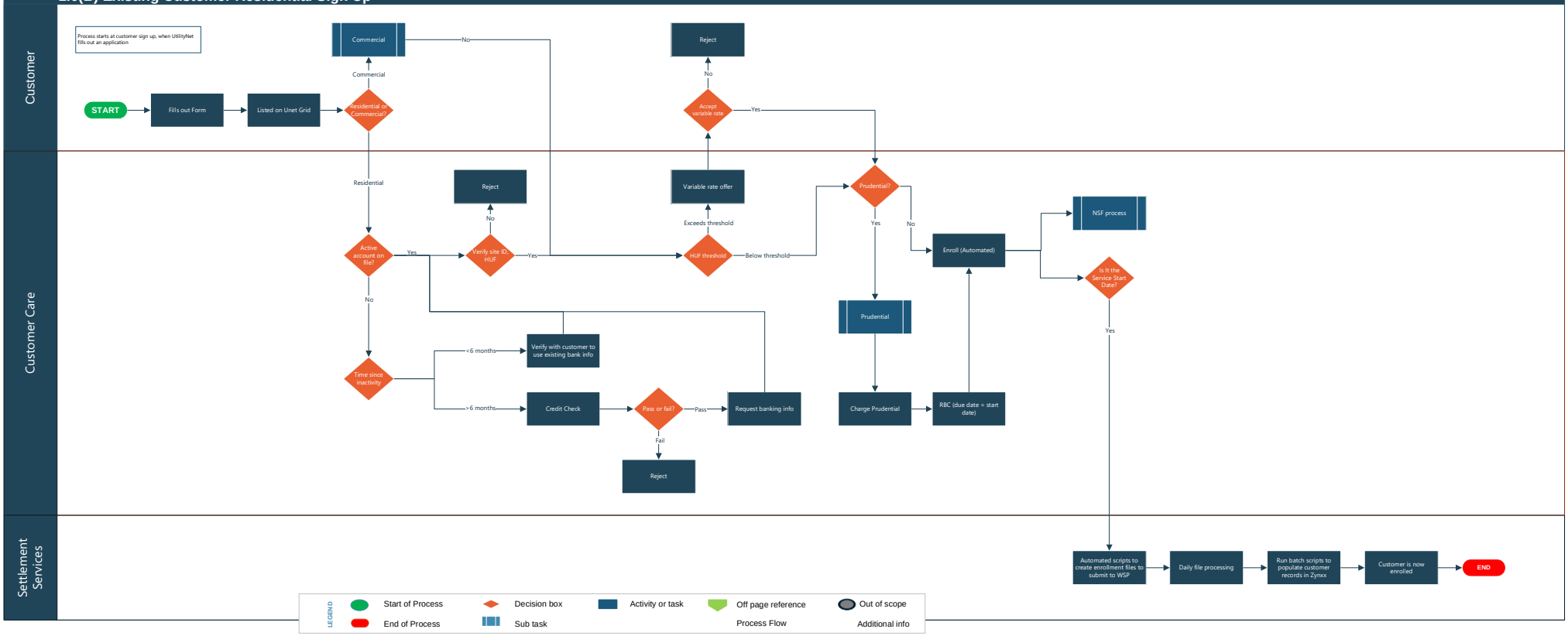



**NOTES:**

1 – Done on the EnergyMarketer (EM) Website by the customer (can also be done by authorized Energy Marketer). Customer is able to choose start date.
2 – All of Customer Care can see the UNET Grid. Assign specific EM duties to each customer service representative to avoid overlap and create clear hierarchy for monitoring.
3 – Commercial included businesses and farms that are incorporated
4 – The recommended threshold for Credit Check fail by UtilityNet is a score of below 600, however the EM's are free to set their own criteria. Email is sent out to customers that have failed. Once rejected, form goes into a bucket that cannot be accessed.
5 – Validate that UtilityNet has all documents to enroll, including request for Void Cheque and Banking information.
6 – Prudential is charged via credit card or etransfer.
7 – At Enrollment Email is sent to customer (automated)
8 – RBC notifies Utilitynet of NSF's 4-5 business days after Prudential has been charged.
9 – Customer stays in "Enrol" Status until the Service Start Date.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

## 1.0(B) Existing Customer Residential Sign Up

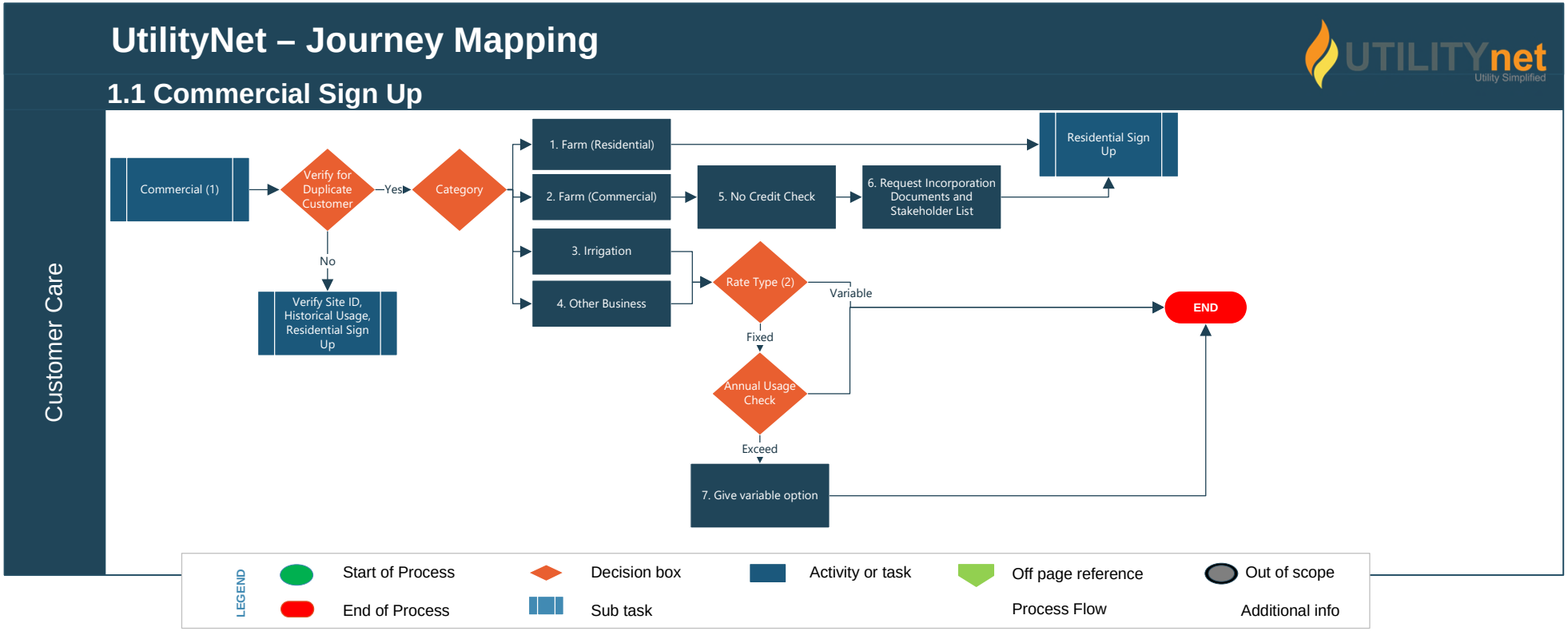



**NOTES:**

1 – Done on the EnergyMarketer (EM) Website by the customer (can also be done by authorized Energy Marketer). Customer is able to choose start date.
2 – All of Customer Care can see the UNET Grid. Assign specific EM duties to each customer service representative to avoid overlap and create clear hierarchy for monitoring.
3 – Commercial included businesses and farms that are incorporated
4 – The recommended threshold for Credit Check fail by UtilityNet is a score of below 600, however the EM's are free to set their own criteria. Email is sent out to customers that have failed. Once rejected, form goes into a bucket that cannot be accessed.
5 – Validate that UtilityNet has all documents to enroll, including request for Void Cheque and Banking information.
6 – Prudential is charged via credit card or etransfer.
7 – At Enrollment Email is sent to customer (automated)
8 – RBC notifies Utilitynet of NSF's 4-5 business days after Prudential has been charged.
9 – Customer stays in "Enrol" Status until the Service Start Date.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

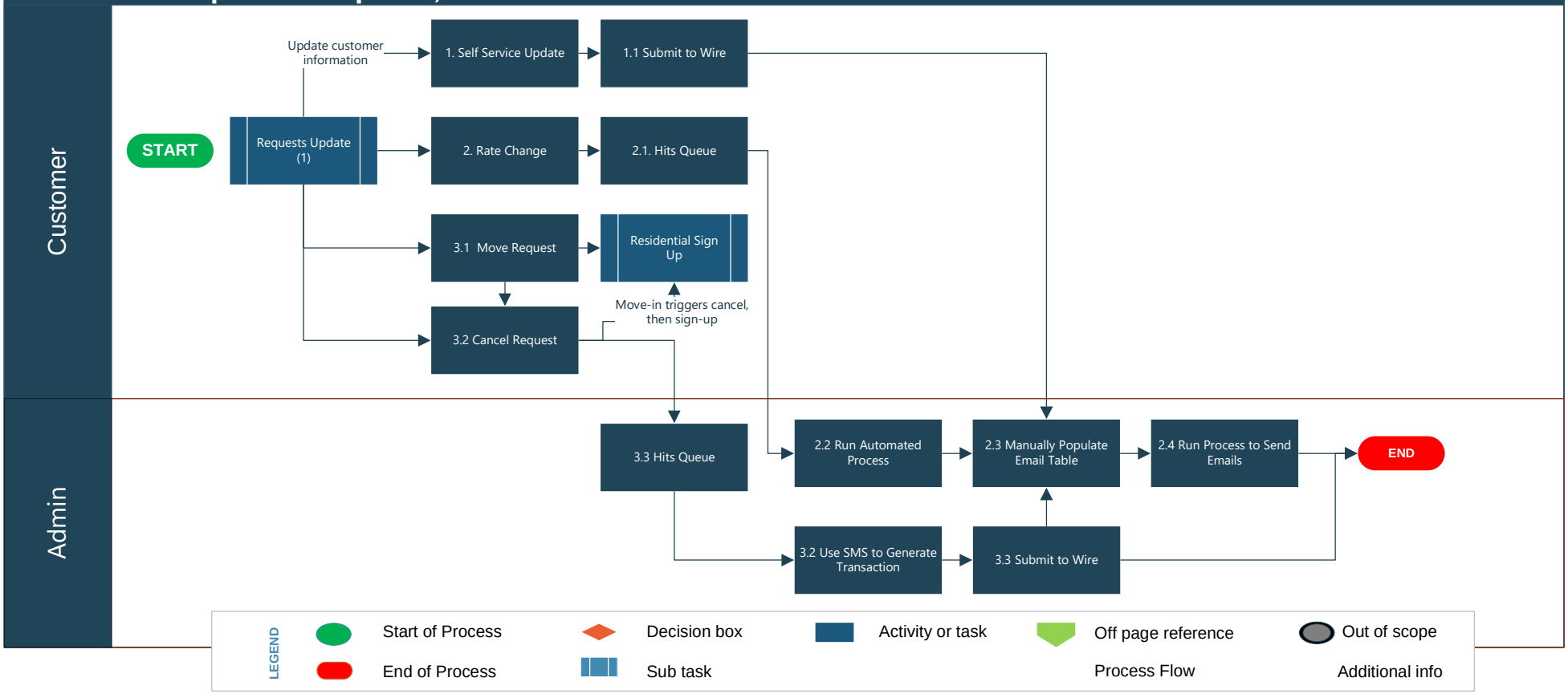
## 1.1 Commercial Sign Up




**NOTES:**
1 – Commercial includes businesses and farms that are incorporated.
2 – Check the customer's annual usage – pass/fail is based on a threshold that varies depending on hedge capacity and whether they chose a fixed or variable rate.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

## 1.2 Request for Update, Move/Cancel

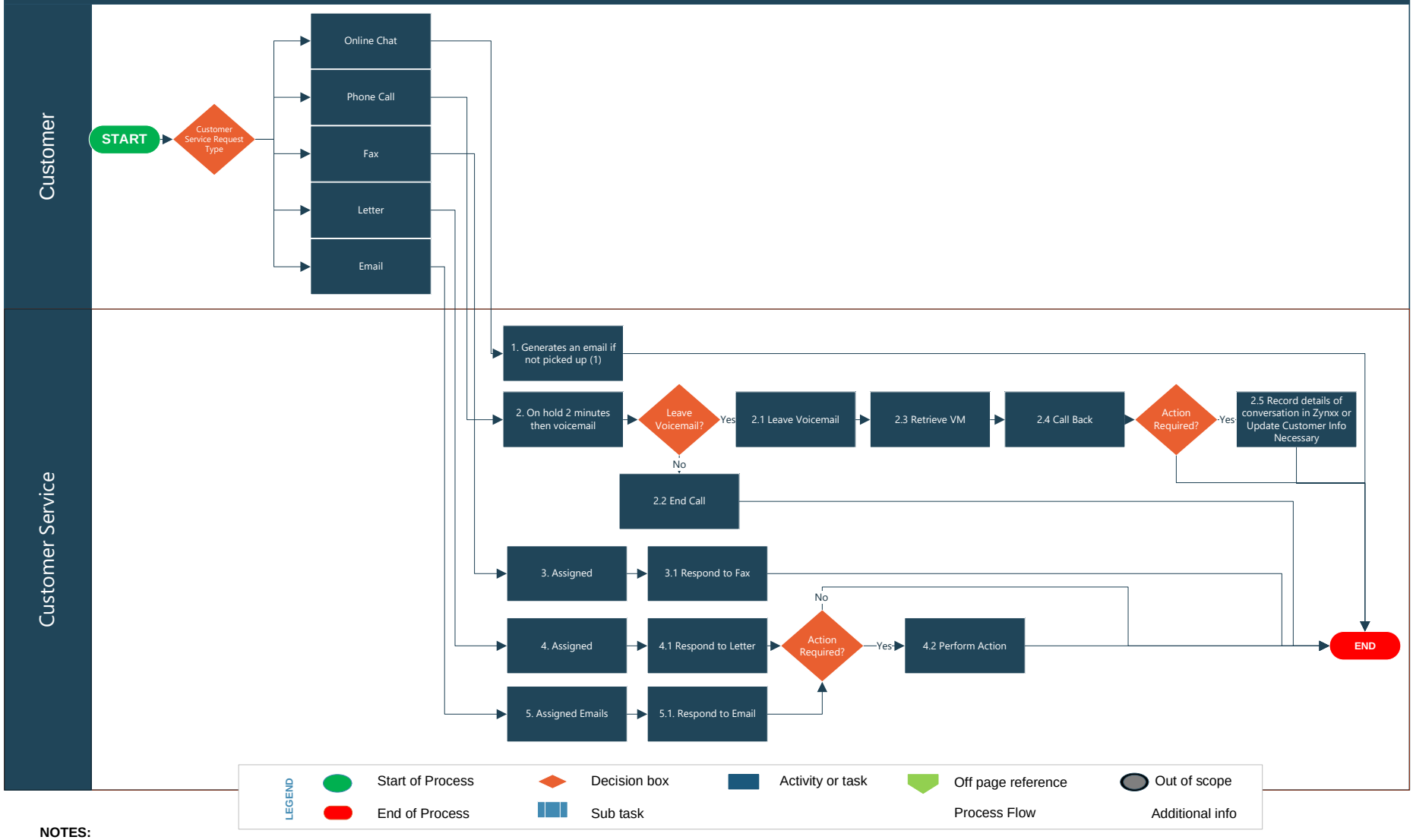



**NOTES:**

1 – Request updates are triggered through MyAccount.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

## 2.0 Customer Service




**NOTES:**

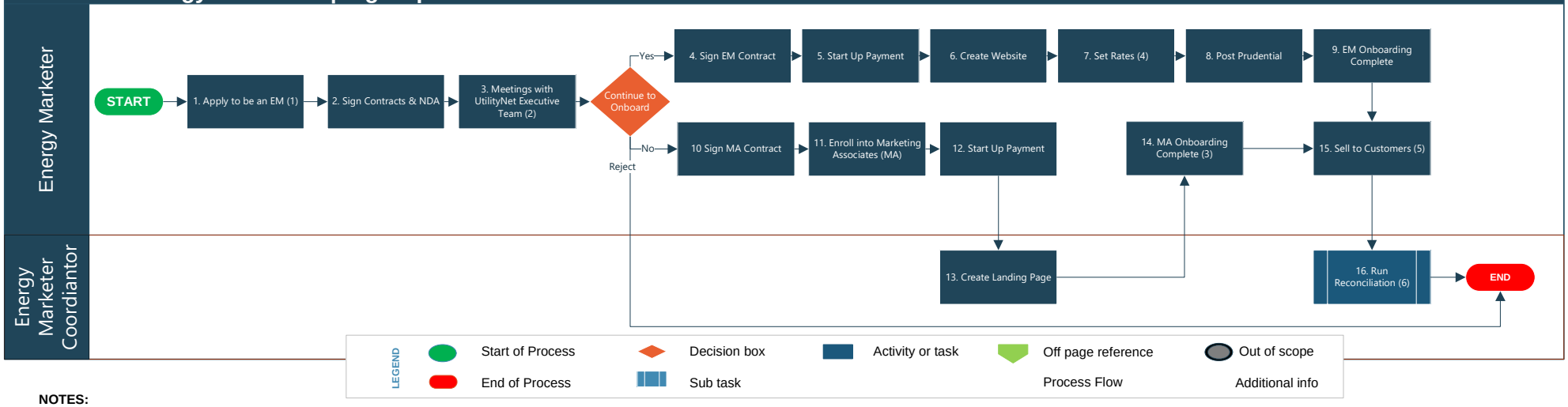
1 – Each agent is assigned specific EMs for handling both emails and letters.

2 – Chats are routed to whoever is available and stored in a central location. All team members log in and pick up chats as they come in.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

Energy Marketer – Run their own business
Marketing Associates – Sell on behalf of the Energy Marketer

## 3.0 Energy Marketers | Sign Up



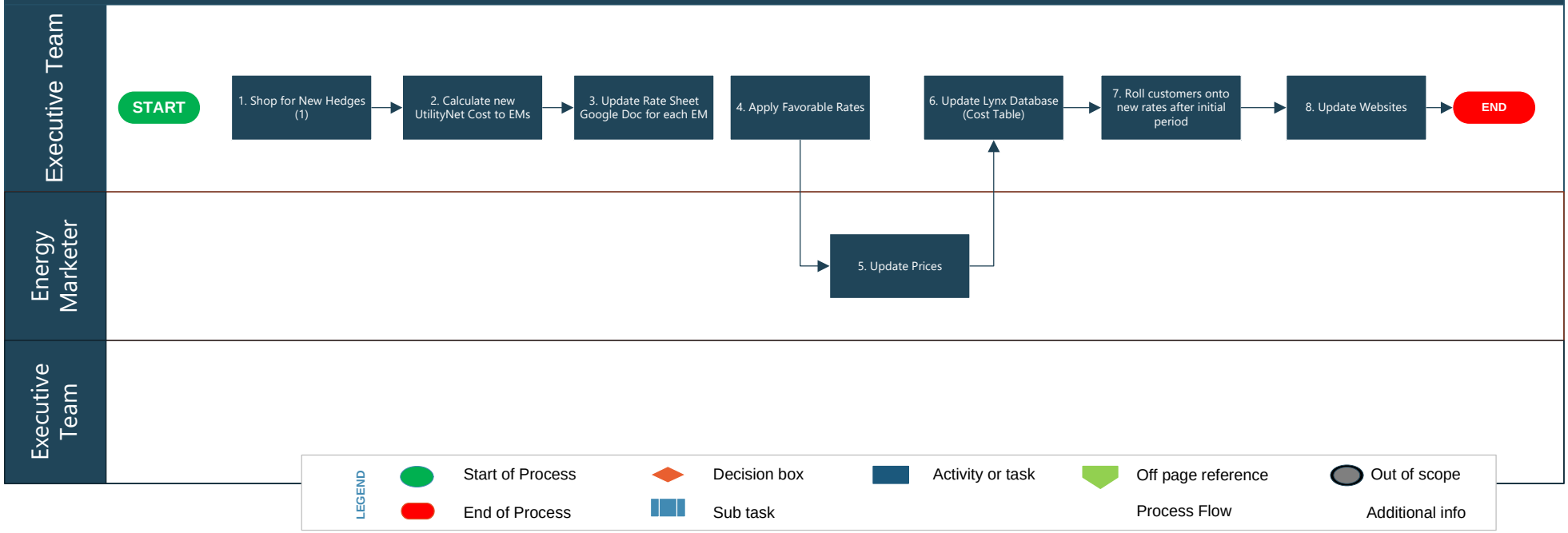

**NOTES:**

1 – UtilityNet has introduction meetings with the potential Energy Marketer (EM) and send contract & NDA's
2 – Meeting with UtilityNet Executives, this meeting would determine if the EM is to continue with onboarding. This decision is reliant on both the Executive Team and the EM's.
3 – The Marketing Associate has been onboarded, at this point they can start signing up customers.
4 – EM sets their own margins. UtilityNet gives the EM the cost, EM sets the price.
5 – Includes one off REC Sales
6 – Reconciliation takes place once a month for Energy Marketers and once a quarter for Marketing Associates.
7 – Shopping for Hedges takes place every quarter.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

Done Quarterly

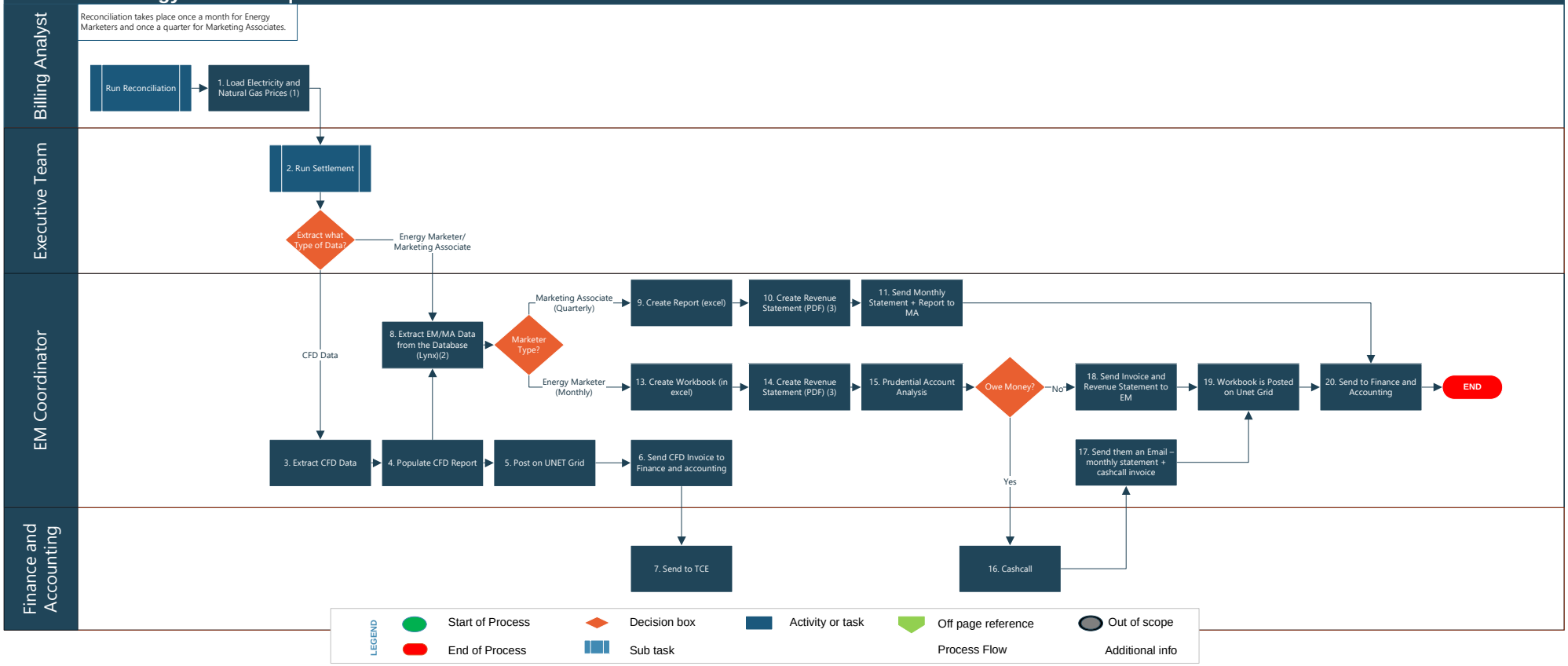
## 3.1 Set Rates




**NOTES:**
1 – Shopping for Hedges takes place every quarter.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

## 3.2 Energy Marketers | Reconciliation

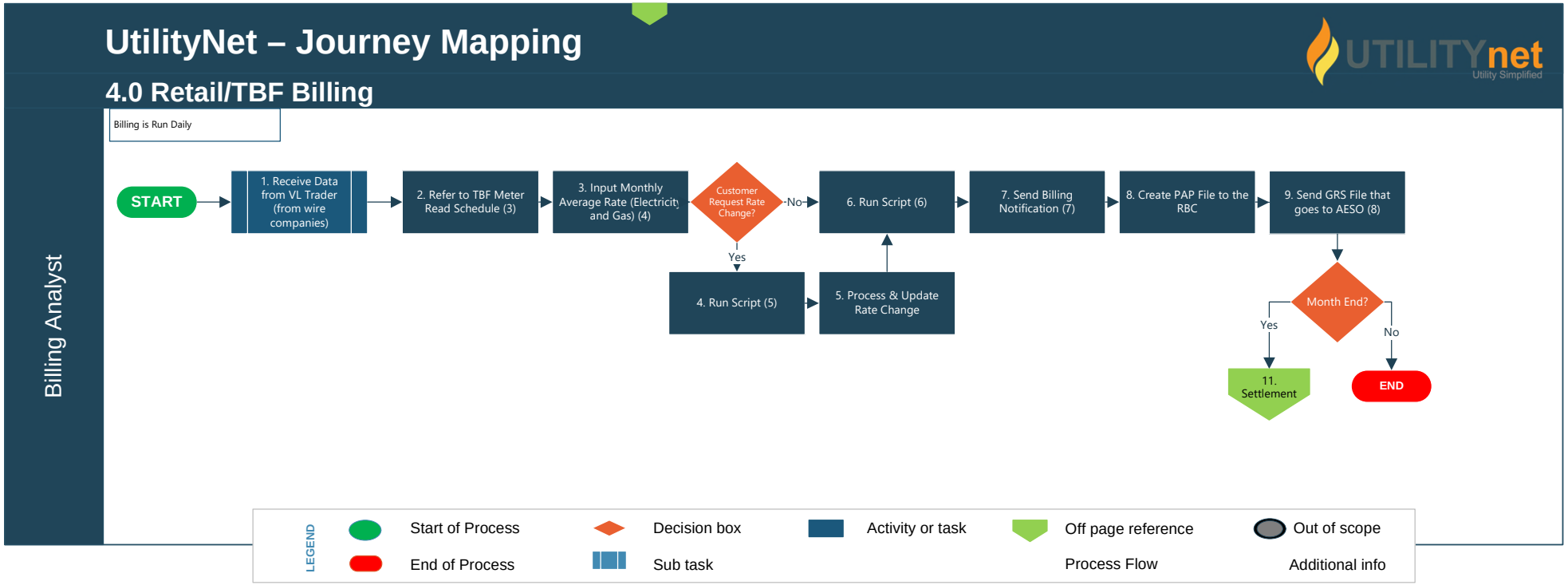



**NOTES:**

1 – Must be run at the beginning of the month after electricity and natural gas prices are loaded – pending data from Wire Companies.
2 – Extract the Energy Marketer (EM) and Marketing Associate (MA) and pull the data into the workbook.
3 – Revenue report shows the EM and MA details on revenue, usage, margin line by line. Each EM gets one separate set of reports.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

## 4.0 Retail/TBF Billing



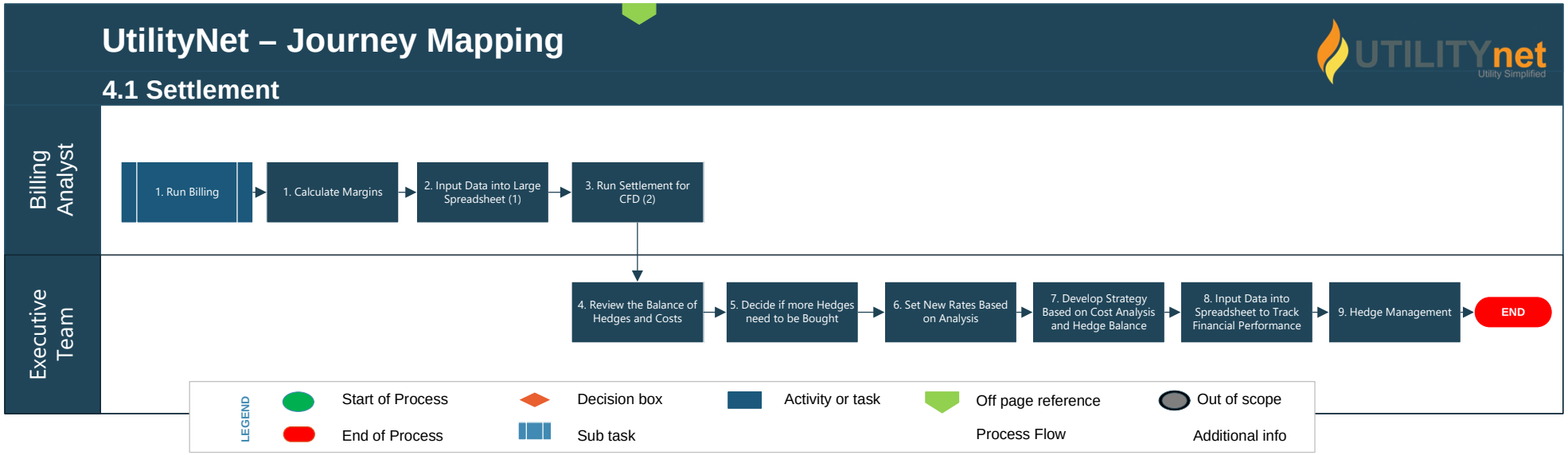

**NOTES:**

1 – Monthly Meter Readings are taken from Wiring Companies. Refer to Process 5.3 Daily File Process
2 – Automatically associate the consumed capacity data with the customer record in the database.
3 – The TBF Meter Read Schedule is provided by the distributer to UtilityNet annually. Based on this schedule, the billing analyst will run the script.
4 – Load the daily rate daily to monitor market trends. Throughout the month, Billing Analyst maintains a rolling 30-day average. At month-end, finalize and lock in the actual variable rate for that month.
5 – The script checks predefined conditions for rate changes. Special cases that fall outside standard criteria are handled manually by a billing analyst.
6 – Run Script will populate the data needed for invoices such as the usage per account, and UtilityNet admin fees. These charges are displayed in XYNX so that Customer Care Team can see. This query is run in Golden. Also makes available the invoice in MyRetailer.
7 – Billing Notification is sent out to customers via email (has dollar amount and due date). Handful of customers want paper bill, which will be sent.
8 – For each microgen, export the data and rate—AESO reimburses the full amount based on the submitted kWh and rate cost.

Throughout this process – the “Bill Run Control” spreadsheet is updated.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

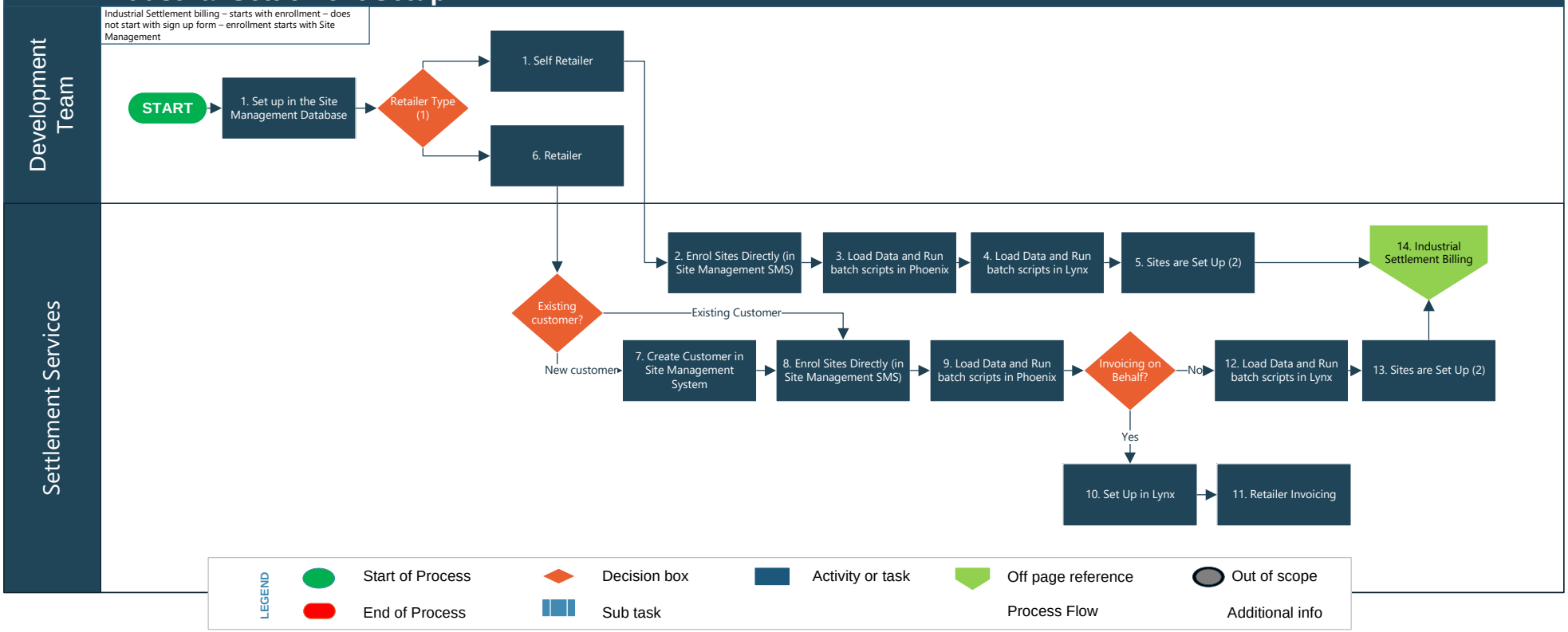
## 4.1 Settlement




**NOTES:**
1 – Determine if the rates are set correctly. This task is performed every four months.
2 – Gross Margin Calculation.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

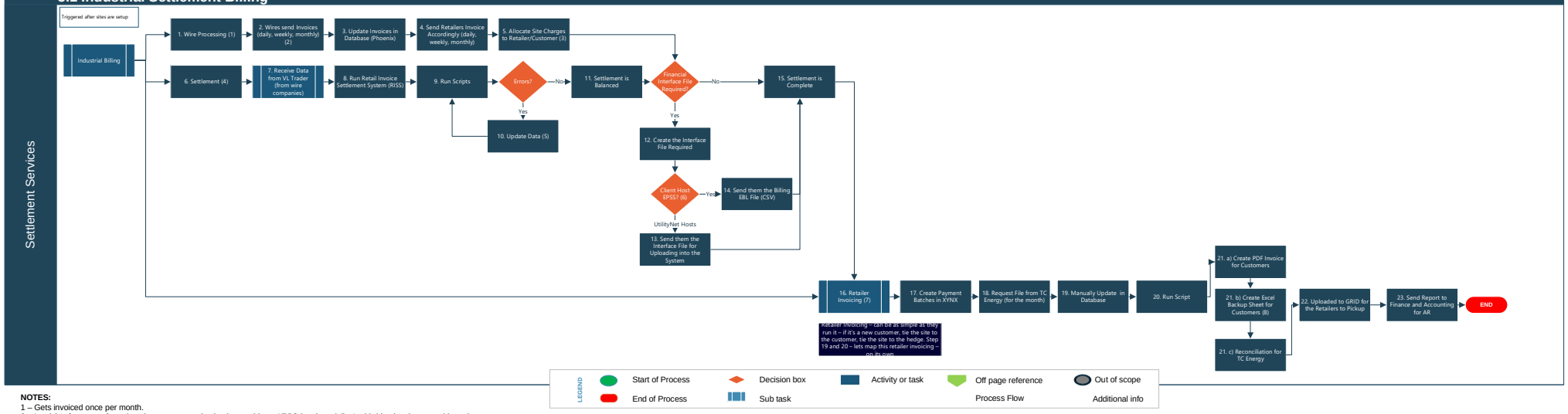
## Industrial Settlement Setup




**NOTES:**
1 – **Self Retailer** enrolls and retains only their own sites – they are their own customers. A **Retailer** serves both their own sites and external customers, similar to an Energy Marketer with multiple clients.
2 – Customer Records are now in site management.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

## 5.1 Industrial Settlement Billing

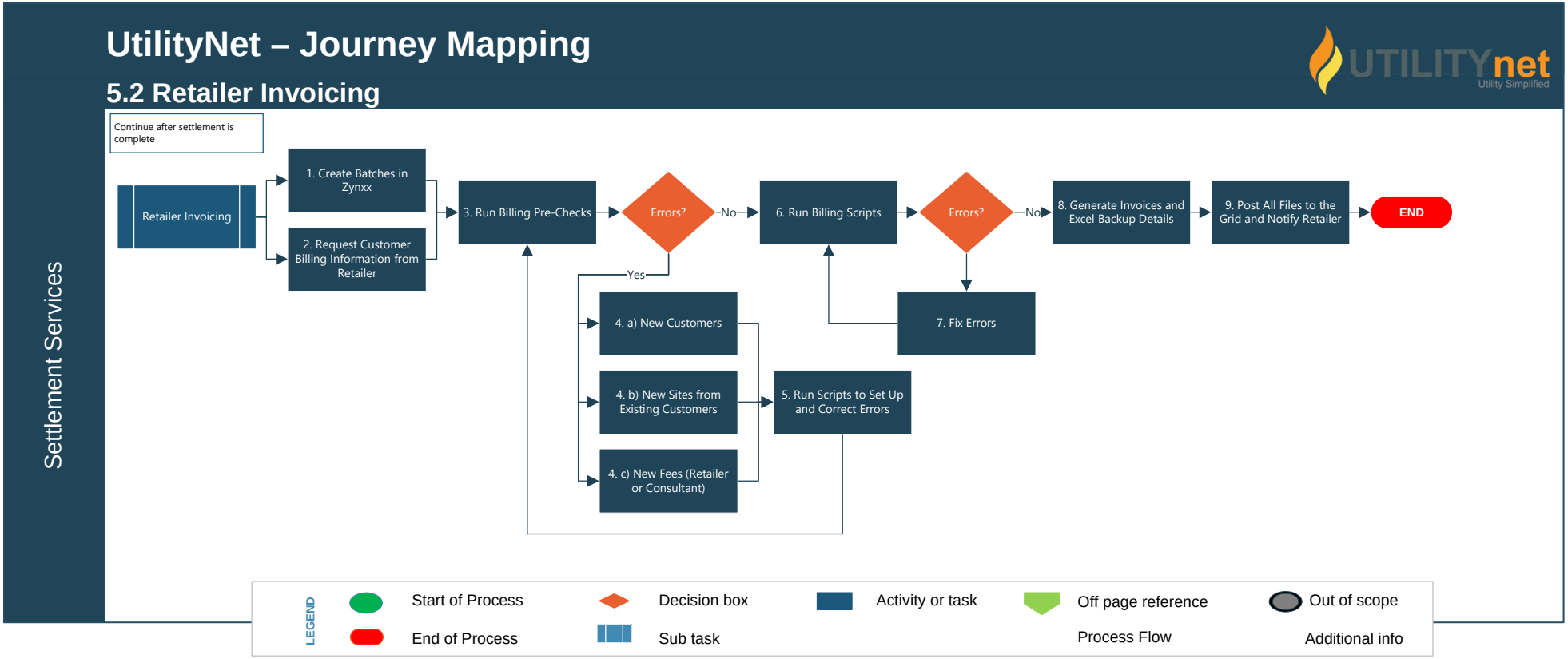



**NOTES:**

1 – Gets invoiced once per month.
2 – Invoicing frequency from the wire company varies by the provider – ATCO invoices daily, Lethbridge invoices monthly and others may invoice weekly.
3 – The invoicing cadence varies by wire company – site charges are allocated to the retailer/customer either in the 1st – 3rd week of the month.
4 – Settlement is handling the data and balancing the AESO invoice.
5 – The errors can consist of mismatched data or characteristics of the site.
6 – Hosting arrangements depend on the customer/retailer – in some cases, UtilityNet hosts EPSS on behalf of the client.
7 – Retailer Invoicing can only be done after settlement is complete. Only do retailer invoicing for TC Energy.
8 – The Spreadsheet has info on the site, usage charges and must be matched to the PDF invoice.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

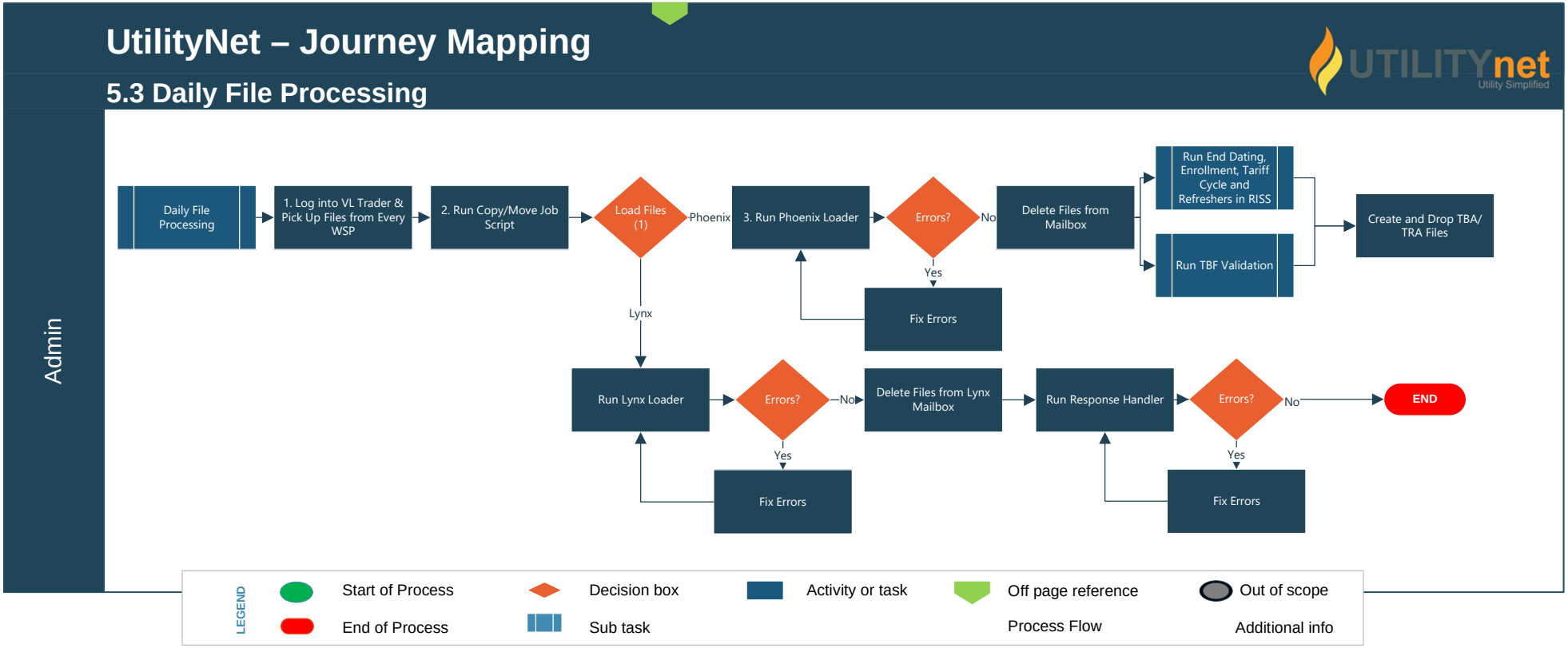
## 5.2 Retailer Invoicing




**NOTES:**
1 – Continues after settlement is complete.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

## 5.3 Daily File Processing



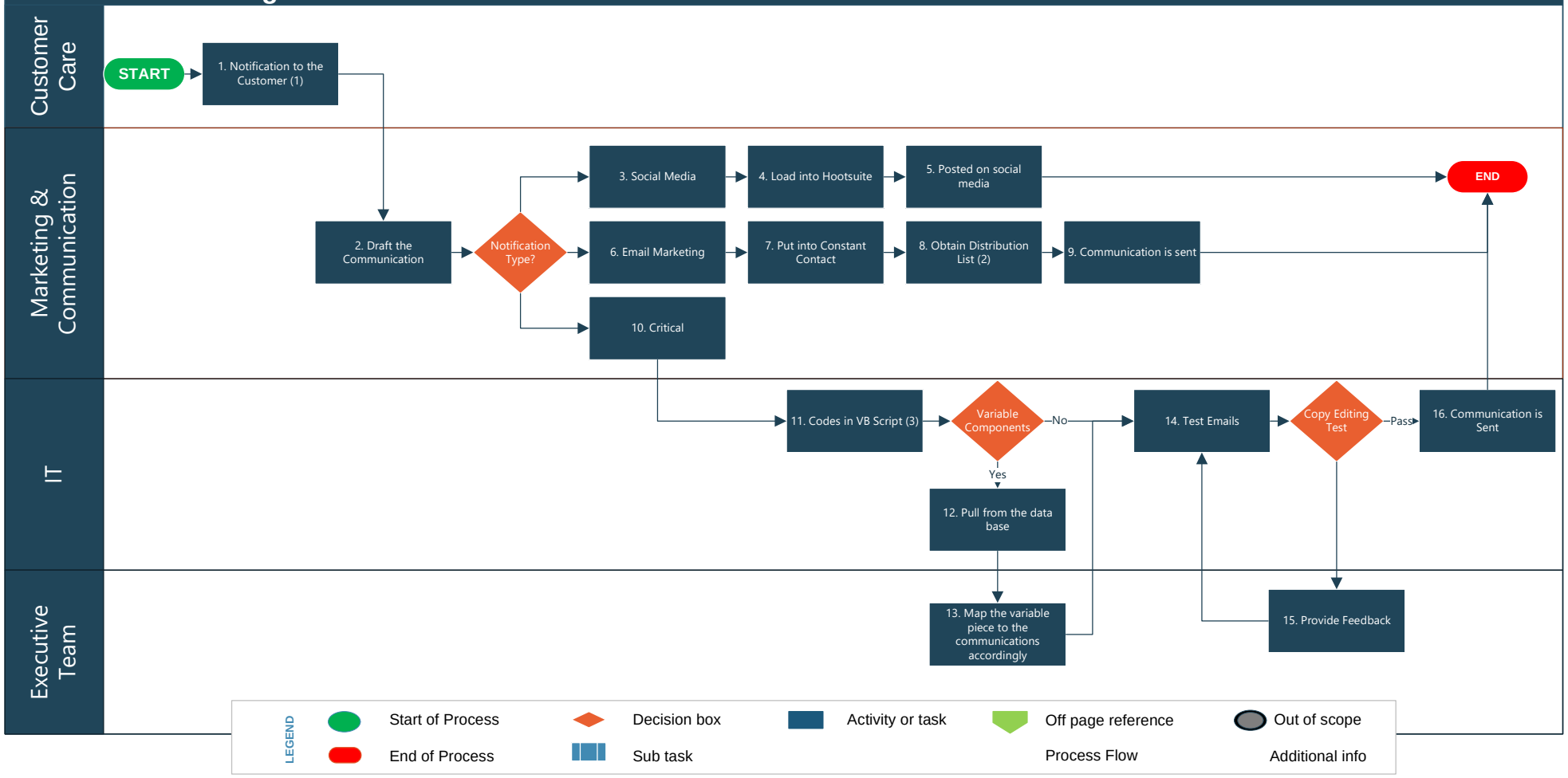

**NOTES:**

1 – Files are generally loaded into Phoenix first and all the subprocesses are completed before loading files into Lynx. This is because the TBA/TBR files created in Phoenix are copied to Lynx for loading.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

## 6.0 Marketing

Future State – would like to gather feedback through surveys + SMS (notifications + feedback)




**NOTES:**

1 – Notifications may be either marketing or critical. *Critical notifications* (sent via VBScript) are exempt from the unsubscribe list. *Marketing notifications* (sent via Constant Contact) adhere to unsubscribe preferences.

2 – Marketing and Communication Team would run query in Golden on what customers would receive this.

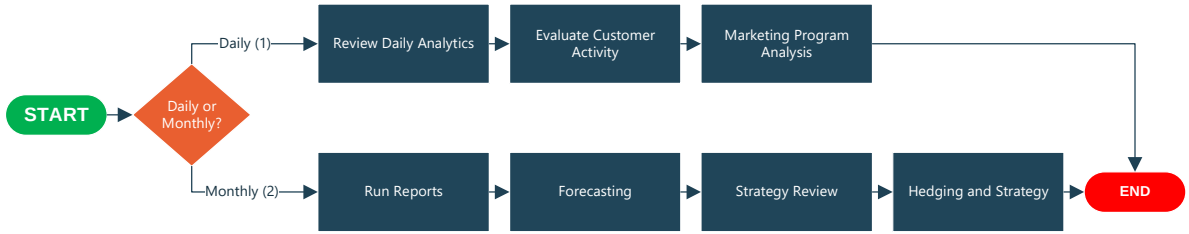
3 – Pre-built templated exist for each energy marketer – the development team uses these templates when running scripts to populate data accordingly.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

## 7.0 Executive Team

Executive Team

Currently, these processes are managed using spreadsheets, which can be cumbersome and time-consuming. Implementing AI and automation could streamline data collection and analysis, allowing for more frequent and accurate updates. This would enhance decision-making and improve the overall efficiency of the business.




LEGEND

- Start of Process
- End of Process
- Decision box
- Sub task
- Activity or task
- Off page reference
- Process Flow
- Out of scope
- Additional info

**NOTES:**

The executive team has outlined a comprehensive approach to managing and forecasting profitability across seven product categories: Electricity, Internet, and Gas (residential, business, and farm). The process involves calculating the CFD Settlement to determine profitability, setting margins, and forecasting usage based on historical data. The team uses Excel for forecasting, updating data regularly to ensure accuracy. The main focus areas include hedging, forecasting, and analysis, with a strong emphasis on monitoring daily and monthly statistics to inform marketing, pricing, purchasing, and hedging strategies. The goal is to optimize profitability while balancing the portfolio across different product categories.

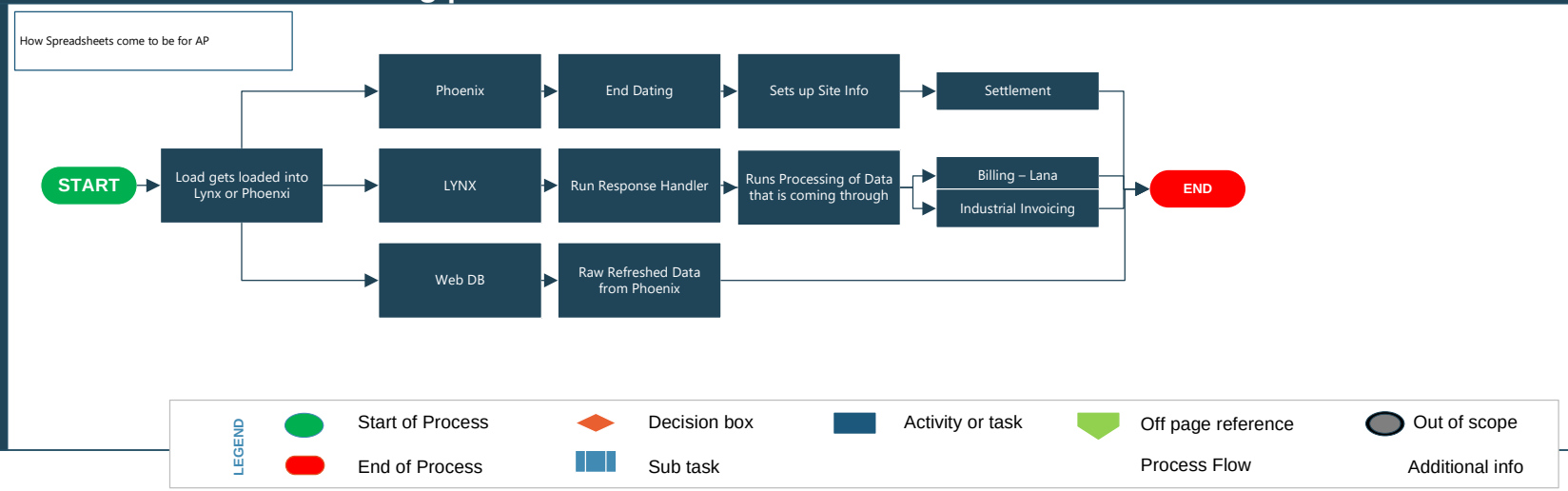
1 – Daily Process includes tracking daily proces changes to adjust hedging strategies. Analyze who is coming on and who is leaving to manage retention efforts. And, map daily stats against marketing programs to evaluate effectiveness.

2 – Monthly process includes generating monthly reports summarizing data by product category, including number of sites, usage, revenue and margines. Forecasting by updating excel with new data to refresh forecasts. Use the consolidated reports to make decisions on marketing, hedigng, pricing and product strategies. Focus on hedging and strategic planning based on monthly data.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

## 8.0 Finance and Accounting | Pre AP

Finance & Accounting Department

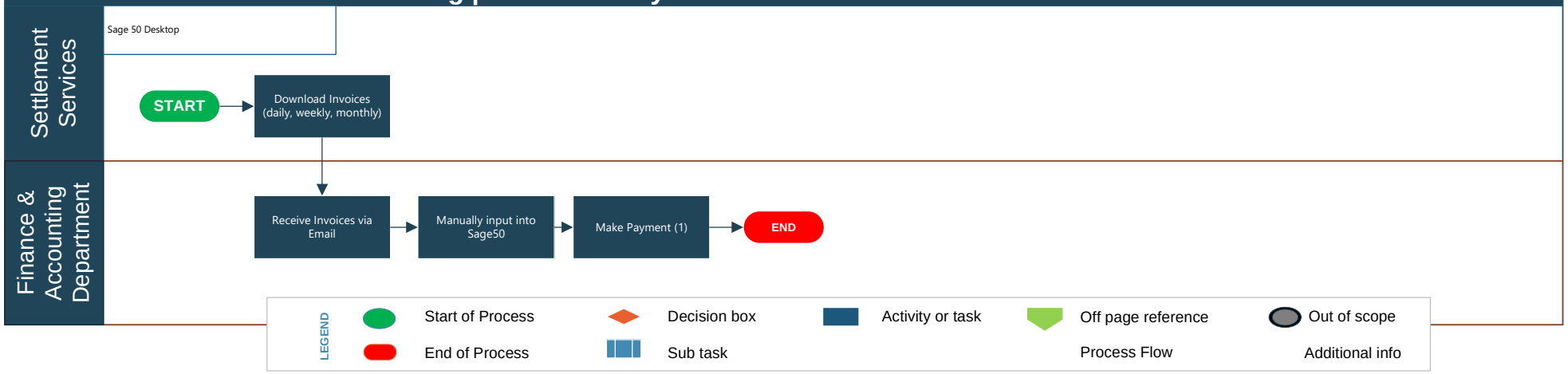



**NOTES:**

**1 –** Partly a reporting database. Some of the data is refreshed from Phoenix – data that is pilled can be accessed by the customer through the portal

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

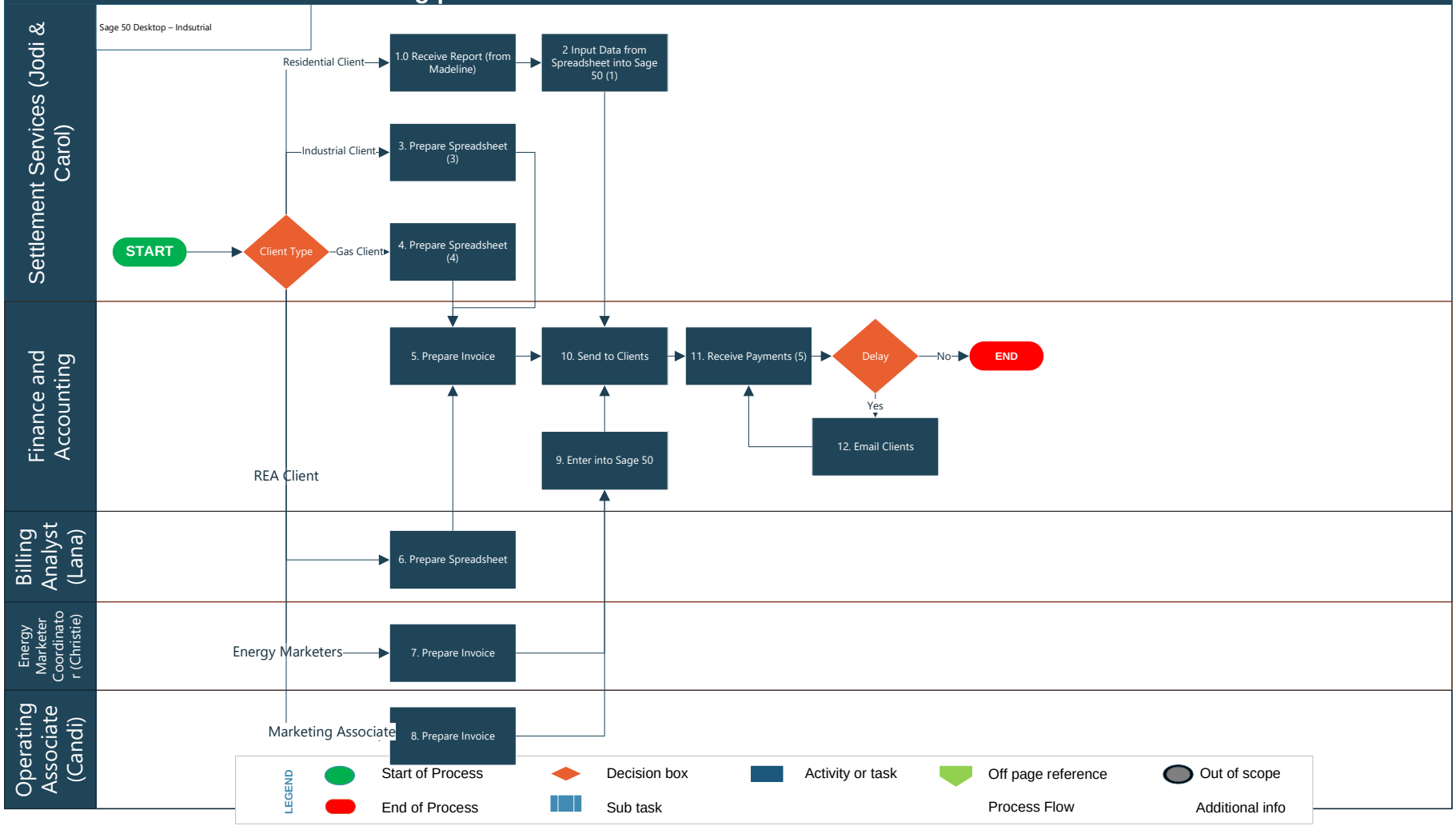
## 8.1 Finance and Accounting | Accounts Payable




**NOTES:**
1 – Payments are made via ECH Payment, E Transfer, Cheque, and Credit Card.

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

## 8.2 Finance and Accounting | Accounts Recievable



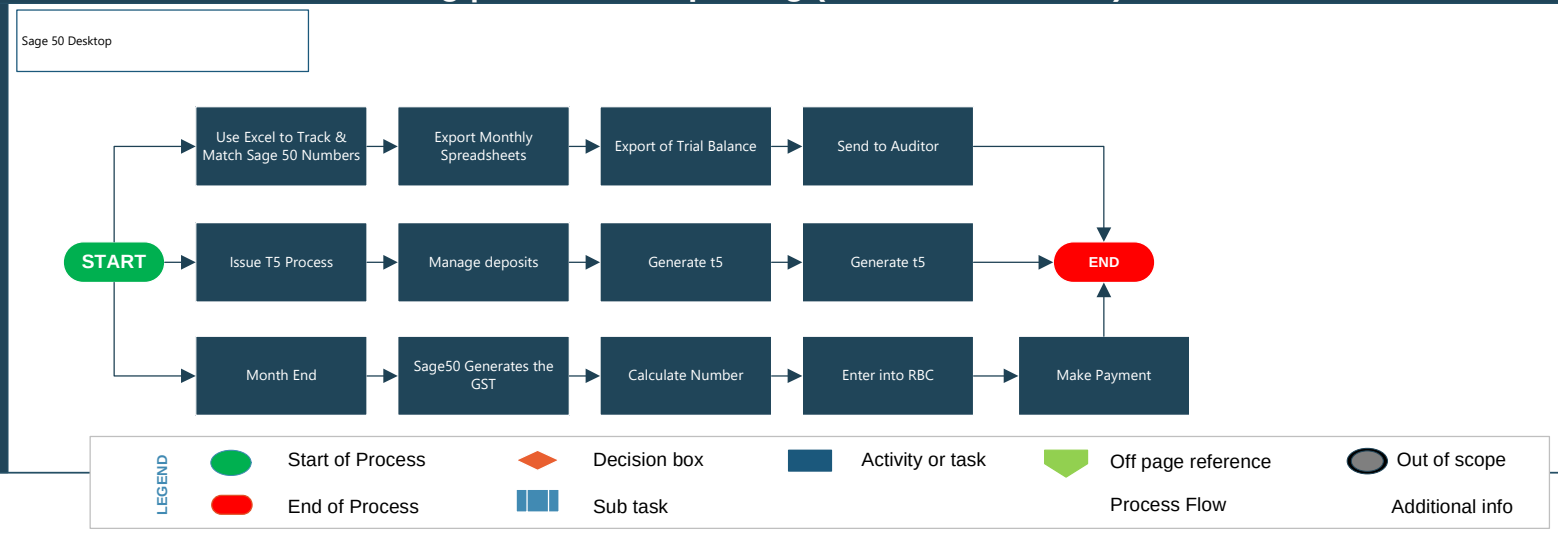

**NOTES:**

1 – The spreadsheet for residential clients has raw data, which is then inputted manually into Sage50. Currently, due to the manual data entry, the copy of data does not match, and can come close.
2 – The spreadsheet for industrial clients includes site details, rate changes, usage. The cadence varies in terms of invoice (refer to 5.1 Industrial Settlement Billing)
3 – Prior to entering the spreadsheet, all data flows through VL Trader—from Wires to UtilityNet. This information is used consistently, as it all originates from the same source. Refer to Process 4.0 Retail/TBF Billing
5 – F/A will let EM Coordinator know that payment has been recieved

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

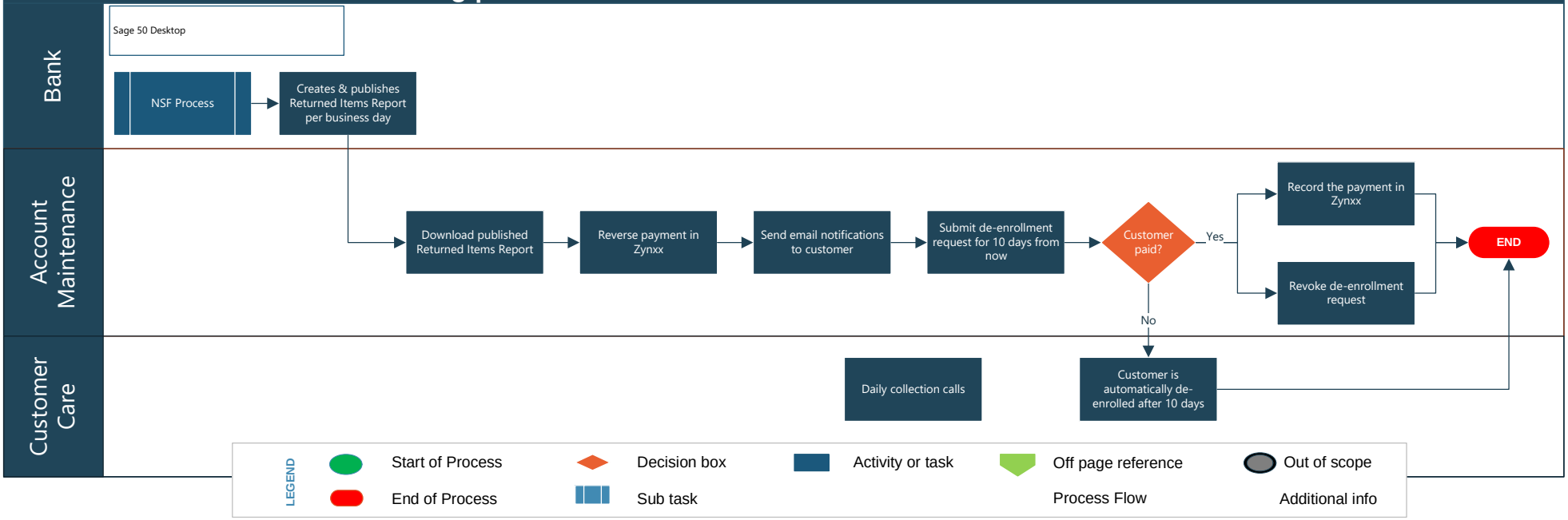
## 8.3 Finance and Accounting | Financial Reporting (Year End Process)

Finance & Accounting Department



# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

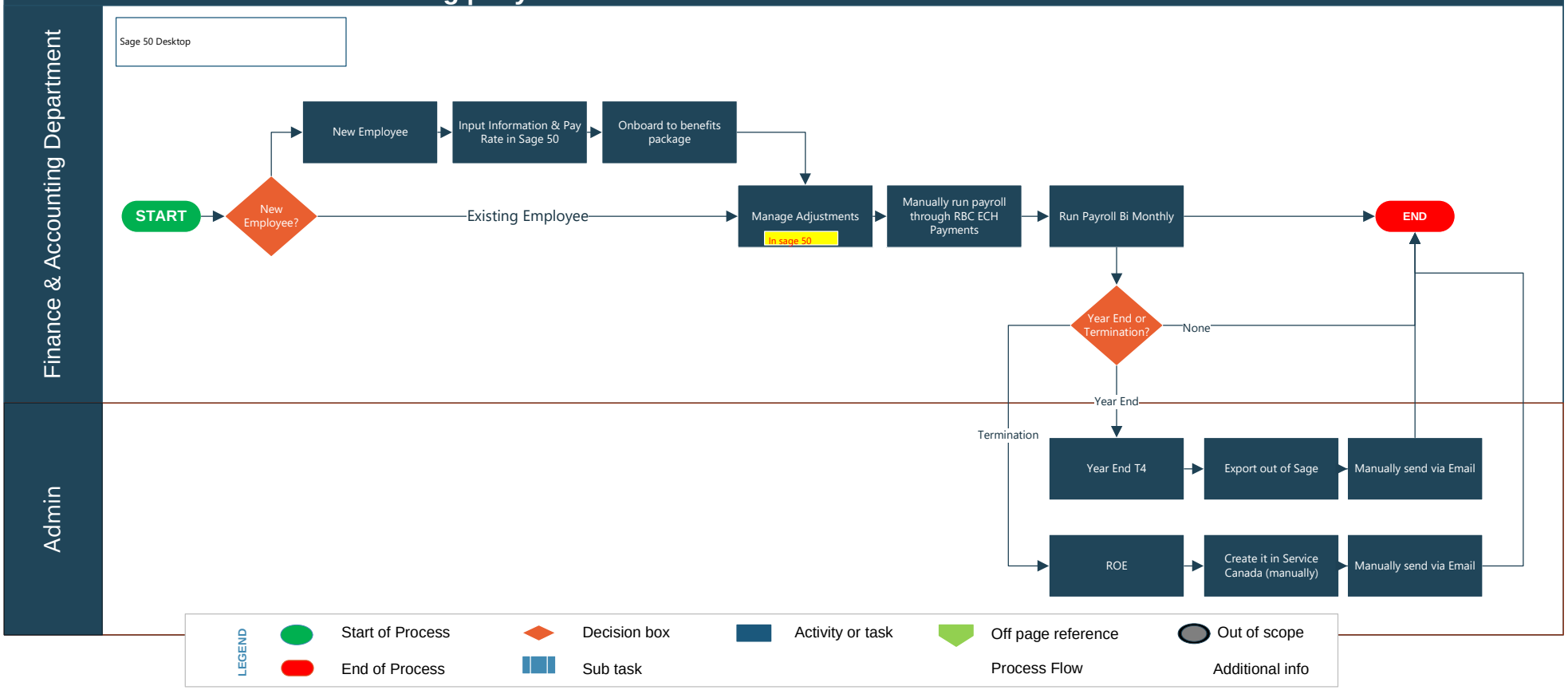
## 8.4 Finance and Accounting | NSF




**NOTES:**
1 – Bank Notifies Utilitynet of NSF 5-7 days after request to process payment (from the due date).
2 – Email notification includes message to customer that they are in NSF. Account Maintenance requests for payment arrangement

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

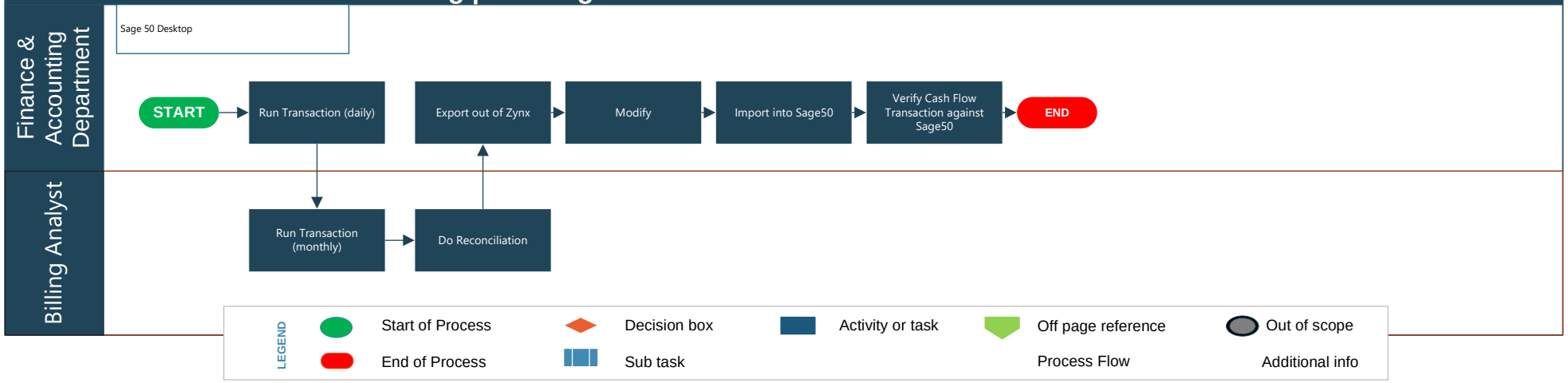
## 8.5 Finance and Accounting | Payroll

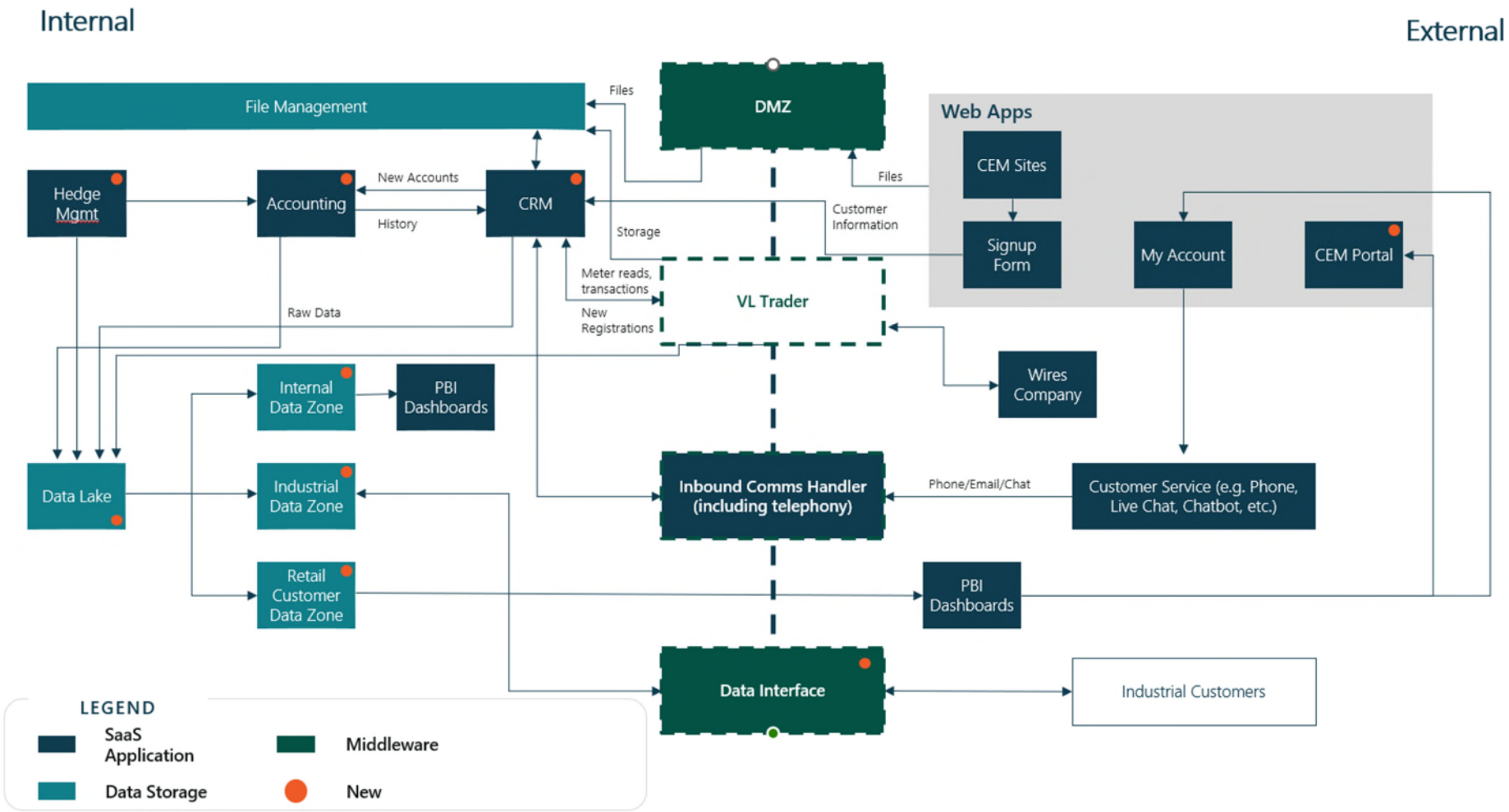



**NOTES:**
1 –

# UtilityNet – Journey Mapping

## 8.6 Finance and Accounting | Banking Reconciliation




**NOTES:**
1 –

## 7.3 Appendix C – UTILITYnet Proposed Future State High-Level Architecture